



CAUSE AND CURE

Everybody is talking of inflammation

Inflammation, the body's response to injuries or illness, has become the universal language through which Internet discusses modern life, ageing, food, and the body

MAGAZINE » PAGE 1

NEARBY



T.N. to appeal against acquittal of Ponnudiy

CHENNAI
The State government will file an appeal against the acquittal of former Minister K. Ponnudiy in a red sand quarrying case, the ED has told the Madras High Court. » PAGE 6

Byelections may test AIADMK's sway over SCs

CHENNAI
The AIADMK, which is contesting bypolls in two reserved constituencies, hopes to improve its voter base among the SCs. » PAGE 6

CLASSIFIEDS » PAGES 7, 8 & 9
MAGAZINE » 8 PAGES
DOWNTOWN » 8 PAGES
(TABLOID) (IN SELECT AREAS)

EC switches to damage control mode after facing flak over SIR

Poll body announces 'special drive' for enrolment of those left out during the SIR; additional declaration with Form 6 only for the SIR period, it says; decisions, coming days after reports of rift within EC, have 'approval of full commission', it notes

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

The Election Commission (EC) on Saturday announced a slew of measures addressing concerns over the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls across the country, including stopping physical hearings for unmapped voters or those with logical discrepancies in their enumeration forms.

It said that the declaration accompanying Form 6 (used for fresh voter registration) is mandatory only during the current SIR process. This in effect means that new voters who seek inclusion in electoral rolls after the ongoing SIR need not submit any such declaration.

The Election Commission

Revised process

The EC, which held a meeting on Saturday, said that any person whose name has got left out during SIR or thereafter may apply to the ERO concerned for inclusion in the electoral rolls

KEY DECISIONS

■ Election officers to immediately launch a special drive for enrolment of electors left out of rolls

■ Declaration attached to Form 6 to be used only for SIR

■ BLOs to visit houses of voters issued notice under SIR

■ A panel with an independent expert from IIT/IIT to review ECINet platform

■ Claims and objections period for SIR in Delhi and Maharashtra extended



CEC Gyanesh Kumar with Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi during a meeting in New Delhi on Saturday. ANI

sion also said that any person whose name has got left out during SIR or thereafter, and any person including young/ first-time voters, may apply to the electoral registration officer (ERO) concerned, for inclusion of their names in the electoral rolls.

A special drive will im-

mediately be launched for their enrolment, it said in a press note.

The SIR process has already been completed in 20 States and Union Territories.

The fresh initiatives of the poll body came after a meeting of the full bench of the commission on Sa-

turday afternoon and days after reports emerged of a rift within the Election Commissioners over these and other issues in the SIR process as well as the internal working of the EC.

'Complete approval'
The Election Commission's press note was pertinently

Congress urges top court to hold CEC accountable

NEW DELHI

The Congress on Saturday urged the Supreme Court to take *suo motu* cognisance of what it described as "illegal and unconstitutional" changes to the voter enrolment process under CEC Gyanesh Kumar while holding him accountable for the changes. » PAGE 11

accompanied by a photograph of all the three Election Commissioners and mentioned that it "has the approval of the full commission".

MORE TIME FOR CLAIMS
» PAGE 11
DISSENT IN THE COMMISSION
» PAGE 17

Jaishankar lashes out at Sharif in UN speech

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

Delivering India's National Statement at the UN General Assembly, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar on Saturday said the country will exercise its right to defend itself against terrorism while focusing on the impact of conflicts on the Global South.

In a response to Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's speech a day before, where he had criticised India for launching Operation Sindoor last year, Mr. Jaishankar said that there could be "no dilution" of the world's zero-tolerance approach to terrorism. "Yesterday, a serial practitioner of terrorism misrepresented facts before this Assembly. Arguments were invoked to normalise terrorism and claim immunity from its consequences," Mr. Jaishankar said, attacking Mr. Sharif's speech, in which he had called Kashmir the "jugular vein" of Pakistan and accused India of human rights violations in the region. Mr. Sharif had also claimed that the BJP government in India unleashed a "reign of terror" against minorities in the country.



S. Jaishankar

"Our right to defend ourselves against terrorism will be exercised," Mr. Jaishankar said, adding that governments indulging in state-sponsored terrorism with a "cross-border purpose" must be held to account.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 11

Golden double



Reign continues: The Indian kabaddi teams maintained their supremacy by retaining the men's and women's titles at the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya on Saturday. The men defeated Iran 40-34 and the women pipped the same opponent 37-34 in the finals. R.V. MOORTHY (REPORT: PAGE 19)

UPSC candidates challenge 'ambiguous' CSE questions

Ashna Butani
NEW DELHI

At least 27 questions in this year's Civil Services Examination (CSE) Prelims, across general studies and aptitude papers, have come under dispute, with candidates claiming that the answers in the provisional answer key released by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) are either incorrect, have no correct answer, or allow more than one possible answer.

At least two groups of aspirants have challenged the questions. The cases



Aspirants have flagged at least 27 questions in CSE Prelims held in May this year. FILE PHOTO

are being heard by the Central Administrative Tribunal.

One group of four candidates has challenged eight questions, while another group of 63 aspirants has challenged 27 questions,

including the eight challenged in the first petition. The candidates argued that many of them missed the cut-off for the Mains examination by only a few marks. The aspirants, who did not wish to be identified, said that a disputed answer is rarely just about one question, as it can render a candidate ineligible for the Mains examination, cost them an entire year of preparation and, for those appearing in their final attempt, end their chances of qualifying.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 11

Police oppose bail petitions of co-accused in Veeramani case

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Police (GCP) have filed a counter affidavit before a Special Court for POCSO cases in Chennai, opposing the bail pleas of Shanthi and her husband, Mahendra Simhan, co-accused in the serial child sexual abuse case allegedly involving Gem Granites proprietor R. Veeramani.

The police said the accused were likely to abscond or evade the investigation and trial if released on bail.

According to the police, on October 6, 2025, the Im-

They say Shanthi and Mahendra Simhan may abscond if released on bail

moral Traffic Prevention Unit of the Central Crime Branch, GCP, received a letter and a pen drive containing information about a video purportedly showing an elderly man physically abusing a girl at a house. The man in the video was later identified as the prime accused, Veeramani, and the crime location as Shanthi's residence.

Based on the complaint, a case was registered un-

der Sections 7 and 8 of the POCSO Act, 2012. After an investigation, Veeramani was booked for offences such as penetrative sexual assault, while Shanthi and Mahendra Simhan were charged with abetment. All three were arrested on August 29 and remanded in judicial custody.

The police allege that the octogenarian industrialist had sexually assaulted several minor girls, and that the victims' statements had been recorded under relevant provisions of law.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 6

Out of sync: Bengaluru AI system mistakes guitar case for pillion rider, issues challan

Rider seeks rectification after getting notice for ₹500 fine; incident draws attention to limitations of AI systems; 'false flag' caused by judgment error; which happens occasionally, says senior official

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

An artificial intelligence (AI)-enabled enforcement camera, installed to detect traffic violations in Bengaluru, recently issued a routine helmet violation challan to a not-so-routine defaulter: a guitar case riding on its owner's back.

Souvik Dutta was travelling on his scooter from Hebbal towards Tin



The photograph involved in the 'false flag' incident in Bengaluru. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Factory with a guitar strapped to his back. The camera apparently

mistook the guitar case for a pillion rider and wrongly identified it as a person travelling without a helmet. A challan, along with a photograph captured by the camera, was subsequently sent to Mr. Dutta's wife, who owns the scooter.

Limitations of system
The incident has drawn attention to the limitations of automated traffic enforcement systems. A senior traffic police officer

admitted that the reported violation by the 'pillion rider' was a 'false flag', caused by an error in judgment by the AI system, which happens occasionally.

Noting that the system has yet to achieve 100% accuracy, the officer said that such violations can be questioned, following which they are verified and rectified.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 11

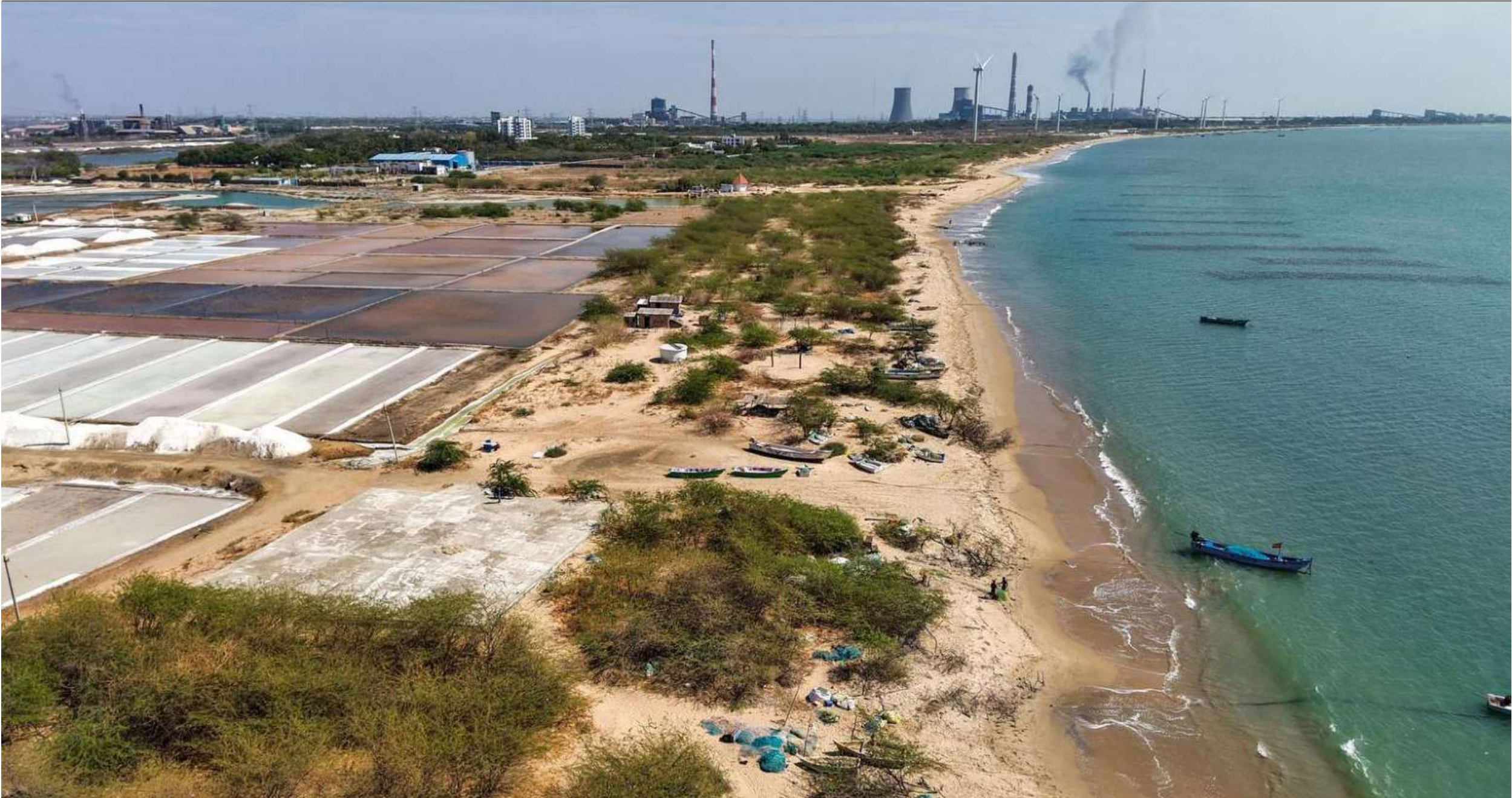
China, U.S. agree to cut tariff, launch AI dialogue

Reuters
SHANGHAI

China said on Saturday it had agreed with the U.S. on a \$30-billion reciprocal tariff-reduction arrangement and on launching a dialogue on AI, under an eight-point consensus reached during President Xi Jinping's visit to the U.S. The two sides also agreed to set up a trade council and extend outcomes of earlier talks, China's Foreign Ministry said.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 18

TAMIL NADU



Mega work in the making: The coastal land and adjacent salt pans identified for the greenfield shipyard in Thoothukudi. In the first phase, around 1,700 acres of land has been identified for the shipyard, one of the major industrial projects proposed for southern Tamil Nadu. N. RAJESH

A southern port to development

The proposed mega greenfield shipyard in Thoothukudi will bring more benefits than the eye can see, not just to the district but also to the entire southern region, writes **Shankari Nivethitha B.**

Thoothukudi, long known as the ‘Pearl City’, is steadily sculpting a new identity, rediscovering its long-ignored potential to emerge as a major maritime-manufacturing hub in Tamil Nadu. A proposed greenfield shipyard in the district is envisaged as the anchor for a new industrial ecosystem in southern Tamil Nadu. The comparison being drawn these days is with Ulsan, the South Korean industrial city known for its shipbuilding and wider industrial ecosystem. Thoothukudi is progressing towards that path, thanks to its strategic location and industrial base, with the proposed mega shipyard expected to serve as the catalyst.

With an investment of about ₹38,000 crore and an envisaged annual capacity of 2.5 million Gross Tonnage (GT), the project is among the major industrial developments proposed for southern Tamil Nadu. Its significance, however, is expected to extend beyond the shipyard itself, with ancillary industries and supporting manufacturing and service activities expected to develop around the anchor facility.

A tripartite Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was recently signed for the development of India’s first mega greenfield shipyard in Thoothukudi. The MoU was signed between HD Korea Shipbuilding & Offshore Engineering Co Ltd (HD KSOE); National Shipbuilding and Heavy Industries Park, Tamil Nadu Limited (NSHIP-TN), a Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) jointly promoted by V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority and State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu (SIPCOT); and Sagarmala Finance Corporation Limited (SMFCL), a Government of India enterprise.

According to a Revenue Department official, in the first phase, around 1,700 acres of land has been identified in the revenue villages of Mullakadu (1), Mullakadu (2), and Pazhayakayal. The identified land comprises 1,660 acres of government *poramboke* land and 40 acres of *patta* land.

The project has recently moved beyond the conceptual stage with the work on a detailed feasibility report (DFR) being taken forward. VOC Port Authority has issued a work order for the DFR, in consultation with HD KSOE, and the inception work has begun at the proposed site. At the same time, a Request for Proposal (RFP) has been floated, inviting global consultants to prepare the detailed project report (DPR), bringing international expertise into the planning and wider maritime manufacturing ecosystem.

Government order

The government order for the transfer of around 1,700 acres for the first phase has been given to SIPCOT, which will build the common infrastructure along with VOC Port Authority.

The significance of the project, however, lies beyond the shipyard itself. A large shipyard can generate demand for a network of industries involved in steel fabrication, marine equipment, electrical systems, welding, machinery and several others. Such an ecosystem, if successfully developed, could create opportunities for small and medium enterprises in and around Thoothukudi district and potentially extend the industrial impact to neighbouring districts. It is this multiplier effect that makes the Ulsan comparison significant. But such a transformation also comes with questions over land, livelihood, and rehabilitation.

There has been concern over the extent of salt-pan land within the proposed project area and the possible impact on the livelihood of salt-pan

Through VinFast, the e-vehicle maker, we are creating an ecosystem for automobile industries in Thoothukudi. Similarly, the proposed shipyard can take the district to a higher level

SANKAR MARIMUTHU, president, All India Chamber of Commerce and Industries, Thoothukudi

labourers, producers, and fishermen. Of the 1,660 acres of government *poramboke* land available, 455 acres had been leased out to Tuticorin Alkali Chemicals and Fertilizers Limited, a sister concern of SPIC, Thoothukudi, and 300 acres to salt producers for the salt pans operated by Kovalam Thanpaadu Uppu Urpathiyalar Sangam and Ponmadasamy matrum 107 Nabargal. Over 150 acres utilised by salt producers are reportedly watercourse *poramboke* land, according to the details available with the Revenue Department.

Enumeration in affected area

A Revenue official said the district administration has undertaken an enumeration of the people dependent on the affected area, including salt-pan workers, fisherfolk families, and salt producers. He said the enumeration identified around 50 fishermen families, 350 labour families, 447 labourers, and 109 salt producers. He said officials have held discussions with the stakeholders of the proposed site on the rehabilitation and compensation measures proposed by the government. He added that the proposed package includes house site *pattas* and government-constructed *pucca* houses, one-time resettlement assistance, and support for fishing boats and out-board motors for the affected fishing families.

For salt producers, the package includes alternative sites in the Vaippar region, development of essential infrastructure for salt production, and one-time resettlement assistance along with other assistance. While for the salt-pan labourers, the rehabilitation measures include skill development and vocational training in maritime and allied trades, priority employment opportunities in the anchor and ancillary sectors, and the option of employment for one eligible member of each family in the industrial cluster or financial assistance through a one-time lump-sum assistance. The official noted that the Revenue Department has recently submitted an estimate of funds required for implementing the rehabilitation measures and addressing other demands raised by stakeholders. For a project that promises to create a new industrial economy, ensuring that people whose livelihood is affected are able to participate in that new economy will be a critical component.

The proposed project is expected to create

15,000 direct jobs upon stabilisation, apart from thousands of jobs through ancillary industries. The scale of employment generation could potentially make skill development one of the most important components of the project. This is expected to strengthen the port-led economy of the State and Thoothukudi’s position as one of the great maritime industrial clusters in the country.

Thoothukudi has a long association with the sea. People in the coastal belt have experience in fishing, boat-building, and marine-related activities. But building large commercial vessels requires specialised skills in areas such as coded welding, steel fabrication, electrical work, and several other specialised trades. This draws attention to the major question: will there be any skill development training for local youth?

Susanta Kumar Purohit, Chairperson of VOC Port Authority, said it had already demonstrated that industry-linked training could lead to employment. He added that a dedicated curriculum would be developed in the skill development programmes provided by the Port Authority, covering areas such as coded welding, steel fabrication, and pipe-fitting, so that local youth could be trained for employment opportunities expected to emerge in and through the proposed shipyard.

A senior official of Guidance Tamil Nadu said there were also active discussions on human resource requirements and action would be taken to develop the workforce required for the project.

Focus on employment opportunities

If the proposed shipyard is to become an anchor for the southern economy, its benefits will depend partly on how effectively local students and youth are connected to emerging employment opportunities. At the same time, the project could also create demand for a new generation of small and medium enterprises.

Sankar Marimuthu, president of the All India Chamber of Commerce and Industries, Thoothukudi, said the familiarity of people in and around Thoothukudi with country boat and mechanised fishing boat construction could provide a better foundation for developing the manpower required for the shipbuilding sector. He added that the proposed shipyard could change the livelihood of the people in the region by creating op-

portunities beyond traditional industries. “Through VinFast, the e-vehicle manufacturer, we are slowly creating an ecosystem for automobile industries in Thoothukudi. Similarly, the proposed shipyard can take the district to a higher level, with further increase in the GDP of the southern districts and the State,” he said.

Faster industrial growth

Edwin Samuel, former chairman, Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), Thoothukudi Zone, said the proposed shipyard is likely to accelerate the industrial growth of Thoothukudi in the coming years. He said the project should be viewed along with other major projects coming up in the region, including the spaceport at Kulasekarapattinam.

Mr. Purohit said the competitive advantage as a shipbuilding destination comes from a combination of scale, strategic location, Thoothukudi’s ability to be an all-weather port, its existing port capabilities, and ability to design a modern shipbuilding ecosystem from the ground up. He added that the proposed development would be located beside an operating all-weather port in India’s southern part, close to major international shipping routes, and with access to deep offshore waters.

He further said Tamil Nadu’s wider industrial strength could also complement the project. The State has an established engineering and manufacturing base, road, rail and air connectivity to the district, and a large technical workforce. These factors could help the shipyard move beyond being an isolated manufacturing facility and become part of a large supply chain.

The real economic impact of the proposed project will not be measured only in terms of the number of vessels constructed in the shipyard. It will also depend on how many ancillary industries, engineering companies, logistics firms, and other service providers emerge around it. For Thoothukudi, this could create a new layer of industrial activity around its existing port-led economy. Mr. Samuel of the CII concurred. He added that the district already has a strong industrial base in sectors such as automobile manufacturing. He emphasised that the proposed shipyard, along with other emerging investment, could therefore add another industrial dimension to the district through increased employment opportunities and real estate development. The project also fits into the Centre’s broader vision of strengthening India’s domestic shipbuilding capacity.

The proposed shipyard could turn the port city that has traditionally been associated with pearls, salt, fishing, and thermal power plants into a major maritime-manufacturing destination.

The senior official of Guidance Tamil Nadu said that if the project is realised as envisioned, it can transform the image of not only Thoothukudi but also that of the southern districts. This would be similar to the development of an automobile manufacturing ecosystem around Sriperumbudur after the entry of Hyundai.

Mr. Purohit clarified that the shipyard is the anchor of the vision, but not the entire vision. The objective is to develop Thoothukudi as an integrated maritime manufacturing cluster.

The road from Ulsan to Thoothukudi need not be measured by comparison across acres or investment figures. Its eventual impact will also be measured by whether the proposed shipyard can create an industrial ecosystem capable of transforming the economic geography of the State.



A helping hand: There has been concern over the extent of salt-pan land falling within the project site and the possible impact on the livelihood of salt-pan labourers and fishermen. The government has worked out a compensation and rehabilitation package. N. RAJESH

A group of people, including students and staff, are gathered in front of the Victoria Public Hall. On the left, there is a commemorative plaque mounted on a stone pillar. The plaque features a circular emblem at the top and a rectangular text area below it. The text on the plaque reads: "IN 1961 THE UNIVERSITY OF SINGAPORE WAS ESTABLISHED AND THE VICTORIA PUBLIC HALL WAS RENAMED THE UNIVERSITY OF SINGAPORE LIBRARY. THE BUILDING WAS DESIGNED BY THE ARCHITECT FREDERICK C. WATSON AND WAS OPENED BY THE GOVERNOR OF SINGAPORE, SIR ROBERT GORDON, ON 15 FEBRUARY 1961." The building in the background is a large, red-brick structure with the words "VICTORIA PUBLIC HALL" inscribed on its facade.

Architects participate in heritage walk, visit historical buildings

They learnt historical facts about the structure, which was designed by

partner, Morphogenesis, made a presentation on architectural projects.

Stormwater drain desilting works to be completed by October 10, says top official

Desilting is also under way in Buckingham Canal at 18 locations, Cooum river at 14 locations, and internal canals in Coimbatore, Tiruchi, and Madurai, says MAWS Secretary Gagandeep Singh Bedi.

A review meeting through video conferencing would be chaired by the Chief Secretary on September 29 with all Collectors. Ministers and IAS officers had been appointed as monitoring officers for Chennai zones, he said.



Municipal Administration and Water Supply Department Secretary Gagandeep Singh Bedi inspecting the ongoing northeast monsoon preparedness works across Chennai zones on Saturday.

Addressing a press meet, Mr. Bedi stated that all local bodies across Tamil Nadu were directed by the Chief Minister to maintain full readiness to face the northeast monsoon. In Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) limits, approximately one lakh silt-catch pits were desilted in the first phase, and second-phase works were ongoing, he said.

The Water Resources Department had allocated ₹42 crore to prevent blockages at river mouths. Dredging operations using specialised machinery were under way at the Cooum river mouth, Adyar, Muthukadu, and North Chennai regions, continuing through December and January, he added.

A joint technical com-

Headmaster arrested for sexually assaulting 12-year-old in school

A 52-year-old government school headmaster was arrested for allegedly sexually assaulting a 12-year-old Class 6 girl within the school premises in Chengalpattu district.

The All-Woman Police, Mamallapuram, arrested Thomas Manoharan, of Bharathi Nagar in Thandalur near Thiruporur, under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, following a complaint from the girl's parents.

On September 19, the girl visited the primary school as part of academic activities. She was assigned the task of checking the

**According to sources
in the Education
Department, he was
later suspended**

answer sheets of students from Classes 1 to 5, the police said. While she was engaged in the work, Manoharan allegedly took her to the headmaster's room and sexually assaulted her.

The girl later returned home and informed her parents, following which they approached the police.

A case was registered under provisions of the POCsO Act and the headmaster was arrested. According to Education Department sources, he was subsequently suspended.

Persons with disabilities organise exhibition

The NGO empowers individuals with disabilities through comprehensive services, education, therapy, and vocational training.

The mela is an effort to provide a networking platform for entrepreneurs



As many as 57 stalls have been put up by persons with disabilities from across the State. V. UMESH KUMAR

who are persons with disabilities. Speaking about the initiative, Kavithaa Narasimhan, product design-

ing and marketing, Vidya Sagar, said that this year was extra special as four micro enterprises under

their programme were transformed into business ventures. "Under the entrepreneurship development programme, we wanted these four to be set up as commercial establishments," she said.

According to a press release, a wide variety of products, including doormats, shopping bags, earrings, coasters, scribbling pads, cups, bowls, saucers, and arts and crafts made by persons with disabilities were showcased.

The two-day event would conclude on September 27.

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The Hindu to conduct webinar on key aspects of vaccination today

Vaccination plays an important role in preventing infectious diseases and reducing the risk of serious illness and complications.

While childhood immunisation is a key part of disease prevention, vaccination needs can continue into adulthood depending on age, health conditions, occupation, travel, and other factors.

The Hindu is hosting a free webinar, 'Vaccines: Armour Against Infectious Diseases', on Sunday from 11.30 a.m. to 12.30 p.m.

The discussion would look at the importance of timely childhood vaccination, completing the recommended schedule, and what parents should do when doses are missed.

It would also address vaccination when a child is unwell, vaccines recommended in specific situa-

tions, and common concerns about vaccine safety and side-effects. The session would also examine adult vaccination and how immunisation needs may change with age.

Speakers at the webinar include Janani Sankar, Medical Director, Kanchi Kamakoti CHILDS Trust Hospital, Chennai, who would discuss childhood vaccination and the practical concerns parents face around immunisation, and Dilip Mathai, senior consultant in Infectious Diseases, Naruvi Hospitals, and Professor of Medicine and Adult Infectious Diseases, who would focus on adult vaccination and immunisation throughout the life course.

The session will be moderated by Athira Elssa Johnson, Senior Reporter, *The Hindu*. To register, scan the QR code:

CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

AAA/Thani

Drama Super Star S.Ve Shekhar's TWO comedy Plays@ Vani Mahal (OBUL REDDY HALL) A/C. T.Nagar OCT 3rd Saturday 7pm. KATHULA POO 4th Sunday 7pm. Mahabharathil Mangatha. Bkg. BookMyshow.com, MDND.com. 9677160240.

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Today at Sathguru Gnanananda Hall, Nerada Gana Sabha.

4.00 PM - "Thillai Theandavarayan" - Thematic Presentation of compositions of Brahmesri Papanasam Sivan on Thillai by "Thamasaandam Music School" of Dr.Shubha Ganesan.

5.00 PM - "Sampadraya Katcheri" Vocal Concert by Vid. Ramakrishnan Murthy with Vid. L.Ramakrishnan and Vid. Trivandrum Balaji.

7.00 PM - "Sivan Yazhivil Cinema" QFR Live - Presented by Subhasree Thanikachalam with Vid.Santhosh Subramaniam, Vid.Rishipriya Guruprasath, Vid. Vigneshwar VG, Vid.Durai Srinivasan, Vid.Sri Hari and Vid.Harishma

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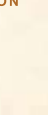














INBRIEF



Gifts presented to children undergoing treatment

Over 20 children undergoing treatment for neurodevelopmental disorders and defects at birth at the District Early Intervention Centre (DEIC), Institute of Social Paediatrics, Government Stanley Medical College Hospital (SMCH), received gifts at an event organised on Saturday. The DEIC, in collaboration with Make-A-Wish Foundation of India, organised the event to fulfil the wishes of children with neurodevelopmental disorders. SMCH Dean A. Aravind, director of the Institute of Social Paediatrics J. Ganesh, Medical Superintendent Jothi Kumar, Resident Medical Officer Vanitha Malar, and State Nodal Officer of the DEIC Thamarai were present. Neda Saba S., chapter head, and Krishna Kumar N., chapter manager, Chennai, of the Make-A-Wish Foundation of India, also took part, the release said.

Construction worker dies after falling on transformer

A 28-year-old construction worker from Jharkhand died after he accidentally fell from the second floor of a house onto an electricity transformer near Padi on September 21. He suffered an electric shock and multiple injuries in the fall. According to the Korattur police, Sanjeev had consumed alcohol on the night of September 21. He was allegedly standing near the staircase on the second floor when he lost his balance and fell onto a transformer nearby. He suffered an electric shock before falling to the ground. He was rushed to a nearby private hospital. After receiving initial treatment, he was referred to the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital for further care. Sanjeev died at the hospital on Friday night.

Corporation plans ₹98.25-cr. overhaul of command centre

GCC to bring more surveillance cameras, flood sensors, rain gauges, pump-monitoring units under its integrated monitoring centre over five years; it also proposes three regional ICCCs

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

At the head of the North-east monsoon, the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has proposed a ₹98.25-crore five-year overhaul of its Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC), bringing 1,256 cameras, 65 rain gauges, 46 flood sensors, and 40 flood-o-meters under an integrated civic monitoring system.

The proposal covers the operation, maintenance and upgrading of the existing ICCC, and the integration of additional infrastructure under ICCC 2.0 through a single system integrator for five years.

The proposed system will also include 101 variable message displays (VMD), 159 Internet of Things (IoT)-based monitoring systems for GCC-owned pumps, 57 enforcement vehicle GPS units, 17 automated boom barriers, 50 smart poles, and three regional ICCCs.

Officials said the existing ICCC has 668 cameras, comprising 400 box cameras, 100 pan-tilt-zoom (PTZ) cameras, 100 solid waste management cameras and 68 flood cameras.

The ICCC 2.0 will add 588 cameras, including 446 solid waste management/intelligent cameras and 142 surveillance came-



Advanced tech: The ICCC 2.0 will provide dashboards, analytics, and an early warning and decision support system, besides connectivity infrastructure and cybersecurity. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

ras, taking the total to 1,256. The system will have 18 environmental sensors and 65 rain gauges, of which 30 rain gauges are part of the existing infrastructure and 35 are proposed under ICCC 2.0.

Boom barriers

The existing system has 46 flood sensors and 100 VMDs, with one additional VMD proposed. ICCC 2.0 will add 40 flood-o-meters, 159 IoT pump-monitoring systems, 57 enforcement vehicle GPS units, 17 automated boom barriers and 50 smart poles.

Three regional ICCCs are also proposed, accord-

ing to an official. The original operation and maintenance contract of this ICCC, set up under the Smart City Mission and functional since 2020, covered 20 quarters and ended in November 2025.

A temporary arrangement has been made for operation and maintenance from June 1 to November 30, 2026, according to the civic body.

The proposed ICCC 2.0 will provide dashboards, analytics, and an early warning system and decision support system, besides cloud and connectivity infrastructure, data protec-

tion and operational support. Departmental data integration and APIs, facility management, technical and application support, help desk and service-level monitoring will also form part of the proposed contract, GCC officials noted.

Open tender

The proposal entails financial implication of ₹98.25 crore for five years, including ₹1.90 crore towards one-time expenditure and ₹96.36 crore towards recurring expenditure.

The final value will be determined through an open competitive tender, GCC officials said.

Within three months of SEBI nod, IIT-M tech fund achieves ₹450-crore first close

Sangeetha Kandavel
CHENNAI

Indian Institute of Technology-Madras, IIT Madras Research Park (IITMRP) and venture capital firm Unicorn India Ventures have achieved the first close of their ₹1,000 crore deep-tech Unicorn Frontier Fund at ₹450 crore.

The ₹450-crore first close is backed by a mix of leading IIT-Madras alumni, including Kris Gopalakrishnan (co-founder of Infosys and chairperson, Axilor Ventures) and prominent family offices, along with institutions, corporates and banks. “We have now achieved the first close of ₹450 crore, within three months of receiving SEBI approval. The final close is expected by December 2026,” said the spokesperson of IITMRP.

Around four start-ups have already been funded through this fund. Chennai-based Hathor, which is developing semi-cryogenic and cryogenic rocket engines for small and medium satellite launch vehicles, is one of them.

Carbelim is another firm that has got funding. Carbelim’s vision is to redefine air quality in our cities through nature-based decarbonization technology. The other two firms include Quanstra, which is developing single-photon detection systems and quantum instrumentation, and Triolt Energy, which is developing next-generation lithium and lithium energy storage solutions.

The fund is looking to invest in IP-led, engineer-



The first close is backed by a mix of IIT-M alumni and family offices, along with institutions, corporates and banks.

ing-heavy deep-tech start-ups, with the majority of the portfolio expected to comprise early-stage companies that have reached Technology Readiness Level (TRL) 3-4.

The fund aims to build a portfolio of around 25 start-ups, with an average cheque size of ₹15-25 crore per start-up. The fund will focus on six high-conviction areas where India has the potential to build globally competitive capabilities, including defence technology (with focus on import substitution); space technology (including space qualified hardware); semiconductors (with an emphasis on fabless design and IP ownership); manufacturing technology, robotics and automation; AI infrastructure/GenAI (including sovereign enterprise AI) and health technology (including solutions aimed at expanding health-care access).

V. Kamakoti, Director, IIT-M, said: “This VC Fund is a humble attempt by IIT-Madras and Unicorn India to support promising start-ups across their respective valleys of hope and rise up to become a Unicorn.”

Sanitation workers to receive ₹50 as food allowance daily

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has issued an order for the payment of a food allowance of ₹50 every day to 24,264 conservancy workers of the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC).

The decision follows a survey in which 92% of conservancy workers expressed a preference for the allowance instead of

the meals currently supplied to them, according to the GCC.

Only for working days

The order was issued to provide “food allowance of ₹50 per worker per day, calculated only for the days attended for work, to be added to the salary every month and paid in cash as an alternative to the meals currently provided, to all 24,264 sanitation workers working under the

A survey among the workers suggested that 92% of them wanted food allowance in cash instead of the meals

Greater Chennai Corporation’s self-help group sanitation workers and private cleaning agencies – Urbaser Sumeet and Chennai Enviro Solutions Private Limited.”

The annual expenditure for the allowance was estimated at ₹44.28 crore and will be met from GCC funds, according to the order issued by the GCC’s Deputy Commissioner (Revenue and Finance), following directions from the GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran.

Food quality

The Government Order issued on September 21 stated that when implement-

ing the meals scheme through the contractor firm, “various complaints were received from sanitation workers, Project Management Consultants (PMC), and Corporation officials regarding the quality of food provided, failure to distribute food at the specified time, hygiene deficiencies prevailing in kitchens, substandard raw materials, and shortcomings in the quality and maintenance of utensils.”

The order further stated that a survey and opinion poll was conducted among sanitation workers of Zones 1 to 15 regarding whether the meals currently provided should continue.

“In that, approximately 92% of workers stated that instead of the meals provided to them, a food allowance should be given in cash, and that it would be very useful for them,” the order read.

DME conducts stray round of counselling for 43 seats in super speciality courses

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Selection Committee, Directorate of Medical Education (DME) and Research is conducting a stray round of counselling for super speciality (DM/ MCh) courses for in-service candidates to fill 43 vacant seats. Of the 43 vacant seats, 10 seats are in DM Neurology, MCh Cardio Vascular and Thoracic Surgery and MCh Paediatric Surgery, and seven seats in MCh Neuro Surgery.

The committee, in a notification, had said that the qualifying percentile for the stray round of super speciality 2025 counselling was lowered to the 30th percentile by the National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences. Earlier this week, it called for online applications for the stray round of counselling.

It published details of 43 vacant seats for State quota for the stray round counselling. Of these, Madras Medical College had 13 vacant seats (seven in MCh Cardio Vascular and Tho-

racic Surgery, five in MCh Paediatric Surgery and one in DM Hepatology), while Tirunelveli Medical College had seven vacant seats (three in DM Neurology and one each in DM Medical Oncology, MCh Neuro Surgery, Paediatric Surgery and Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery).

Registration for the stray round counselling was done from 10 a.m. to 2 p.m. on Saturday, followed by choice filling/locking from 4 p.m. on Saturday to noon on Sunday (September 27). The counselling was exclusively for in-service candidates of Tamil Nadu, it said.

It may be recalled that the State surrendered 151 unfilled super speciality seats meant for in-service candidates for the All India Quota second round of counselling. In a case relating to super speciality seats, the Union government informed the Supreme Court that it would return 40 of these seats that remained unfilled after the second round of counselling to Tamil Nadu.

THOOTHUKUDI CITY MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
E-TENDER NOTICE (Two Cover System)
File No: E3/1394/2026 Dated : 25.09.2026
The Commissioner, Thoothukudi City Municipal Corporation is inviting to sealed Tender for the work of Operation and Maintenance of LED Street Lights including routine break down maintenance and preventive Maintenance works in 60 wards of Thoothukudi city Municipal corporation for a period of 2 years Under General Fund 2026-2027

Contract Value	: 378.00 Lakhs
Bid documents/ Web site address	: https://intenders.gov.in
Tender Schedule download	: From 05.10.2026 at 10.00 A.M to 21.10.2026 upto 3.00 P.M
EMD Amount (Payment Remittance is Only Online)	: Rs.378000/-
Pre-Bid Meeting	: 13.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M, Corporation Main Office
Last Date of Submission of Bids	: 21.10.2026 upto 3.00 P.M
Date, Time, and Place of Opening (Technical Bid)	: 21.10.2026 at 3.30 P.M at Corporation Main Office

Online Bidders are requested to upload Bid Documents following the instructions. If any Corrigendum / Addendum will be published Only in the aforesaid Government Websites.
Commissioner,
DIPRI/ 2955 /TENDER/2026 Thoothukudi City Municipal Corporation

CSIR FOUNDATION DAY CELEBRATIONS

Open Day

Monday, 28 September 2026
9.30 a.m. to 4.00 p.m.

All are welcome

Display of Research Facilities and demonstration of Scientific and Industrial Project activities

AIMING TO REACH OUT TO ENGINEERING & SCIENCE STUDENTS, ACADEMICIANS & ENTREPRENEURS
at
CSIR - Structural Engineering Research Centre and
CSIR Madras Complex (CECRI, CEERI, CSIO, NEERI, NML)
CSIR Road, Taramani, Chennai - 600 113.
(Free transport from Kasturiba Nagar Rly. Station & Back)
For details : serc.res.in, www.csircmc.res.in /
e-mail: bkmd.serc@csir.res.in Ph: 044 - 2254 9124 / 125

कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन, भारत
EMPLOYEES' PROVIDENT FUND ORGANISATION
(Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt. of India)
REGIONAL OFFICE-PUDUCHERRY, 101, 100 Feet Road, Mudaliarpet, Pudukcherry - 605 004. Phone: 0413-2353055. Email: ro.puducherry@epfindia.gov.in

No.TN/RO/PDY/NAN 2.0/2026-27 **Date: 24.09.2026**

PRESS NOTE
NAN 2.0 (Nidhi Apke Nikat- PF Near You) is conducted by EPFO on 28.09.2026 (Monday) between 9:00 AM and 5:45 PM at the following venues of the districts mentioned below:

Regional Office Name	District Name	Venue
PUDUCHERRY	PUDUCHERRY	M/s. NITHYA PACKAGING PVT LTD SATHIKUPPAM, ODIYAMPATTU, PUDUCHERRY- 605 110.
	KARAIKAL	M/s VIDYODAYA HIGH SCHOOL, 147, SETHILAL NAGAR, KARAIKAL- 609 602.

The following activities will be conducted during the program.

- Orientation program for newly covered establishments with focus on EPF & MP Act, duties and responsibilities of Employers and Employees.
- Online services for Employers/Principal Employers/Contractors.
- Online services for Employees.
- Awareness Program on New initiatives/reforms.
- Interaction with Exempted Establishments of EPFO
- Redressing the grievances from Members/Pensioners, Insured Persons & Beneficiaries and Employers.
- Facilitate submission of Digital Life Certificate by pensioners of EPFO.
- Providing assistance to seed UAN KYCs, file e-Nomination and upload the details of contractors.
- Awareness on In-operative Accounts.
- Employees' Enrolment Scheme

A. PRADHAN MANTRI VIKSIT BHARAT ROZGAR
B. SPECIAL CAMP for Resolution of Pending Consumer Forum Cases
C. Exemption, cancellation and surrender of EPF Exemption and credit of past accumulations:

- Awareness on Exempted Establishments & Trust Mechanism
- Grounds for Cancellation/Surrender of Exemption (noncompliance, poor fund management, voluntary surrender)
- Regulatory Compliance Requirements for Trusts (EPFO norms, investment guidelines)
- Process of Surrender/Cancellation of Exemption (procedural steps & approvals)
- Transfer of Past Accumulations to EPFO (end-to-end mechanism)
- Verification & Reconciliation of Trust Accounts (audit, correctness of balances)
- Ensuring Timely Credit to Member Accounts (interest protection & transparency)
- Post-transfer Member Facilitation (passbook update, claim services, grievance handling)

D. New Initiatives/systemic reforms*
Joint Declaration, self-correction of details, member ID linking, transfer of accounts without employer intervention, Filing online claims without uploading images of cheque leaves or attested bank passbooks, etc. Inoperative accounts, Employees' Enrolment Scheme, Industrial Accidents, EDLI reforms, CPPS, Aadhar Bank seeding, Aadhar UAN seeding, etc.
All concerned are therefore requested to kindly make use of the camp for assistance.

-sd-
(V SATHISH KUMAR)
Regional PF Commissioner, Regional Office, Pudukcherry

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH
K.N.KARUNAKARA KURUP (72), Retired Senior Associate Editor, The Hindu Businessline, Mumbai passed away on 26-September-2026. Address :Kadamankottu House, Kurampala South PO, Pandalam , Pathanamthitta District, PIN: 689501. Ct: 9029018695

REMEMBRANCE
KAVIGNAR S.KARUNANANDHAM
BORN: 15.10.1925 DIED: 27.9.1989
FAMILY MEMBERS

DEATH

Dr G Sivaprakasam
Eye Specialist
Retd. Senior Civil Surgeon
Govt Ophthalmic Hospital
Egmore Chennai was living in Anna Nagar for the past fifty years passed away on 11.09.2026

OBITUARY

Smt. VISALAM ESWARAN
With profound grief, we announce the sad demise of our beloved mother Aged 80 Years who passed away peacefully on 25/09/2026. Her love, kindness and cherished memories will remain forever in our hearts.
Om Shanthi
Mourned by
Rajeswari & Mayurnathan, Hema & Venkatraman
Annapoorani & Krishnan and Family
Grand Children
Vijay, Aditya, Radhika, Bhaskar, Harini, Aparna
Cell : 98400 93745

DEATH
IN LOVING MEMORY

G. A. JOHN
3rd October 1931 - 25th September, 2026
Thanksgiving Prayer Meeting
27th September, 2026 @ 12.00 pm
6/22, Q Block, Anna Nagar, Chennai - 40
wife
Beatrice John
Ferdinand, Manuel, Sundari
91766 50628 / 94440 82750 / 96772 29831

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES
NINTH ANNIVERSARY

T.J.Thomas
Formerly D.L.G. of Prisons, Tamil Nadu
ENTERED ETERNITY ON 27.09.2017
"The memory of the just is blessed."
Proverbs 10:7
REMEMBERED WITH LOVE BY
Son: T. Joseph & Family Members

A CH-CHE

INBRIEF



SRMIST holds national techno-management fest

The 20th edition of SRM Institute of Science and Technology’s (SRMIST) national techno-management fest, Aaruush ’26, was held on the theme “Towards Infinity”, showcasing emerging technologies and student innovations on Saturday, a press release said. The fest featured drones, robotics, autonomous systems, defence technology, and immersive technologies. Exhibits included DRDO’s BMP-2 Tanker, Bumblebee, RoboDog, and Robotic Interactive Suit, besides live FPV drone demonstrations, VR experiences and autonomous mobile robots, the release said. Student teams also showcased custom-built drones, rockets, and robotics through events such as Quadcopter and RoboLeague. The event offered prizes worth over ₹10 lakh across competitions covering technology, entrepreneurship, management and innovation.

A long wait for second access point at OTA-Nanganallur Road Metro station

The structure, being built at a cost of ₹8.52 cr., would provide access to passengers coming from airport towards Alandur; owing to non-availability of the second entry-exit point, passengers are compelled to take a detour to reach the station

TRACK TALES

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

More than a year since its announcement, Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) is yet to finish the construction of a second entry/exit point at the OTA-Nanganallur Road Metro station.

In the 54-km Phase I and Phase I extension network, the OTA-Nanganallur Road Metro station is part of the Wimco Nagar Depot-Chennai Airport corridor.

While most of the stations in the Phase I network have three to four entry/exit



Much-needed facility: Work under way at the OTA-Nanganallur Road station to construct the second entry/exit point. An official said the work might be finished in another six months. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

OTA-Nanganallur was among the few which had only one entry/exit (situated in the direction of vehicle flow from Alandur to

Chennai Airport). Many years after its opening, the CMRL finally got the land to construct the facility in August 2025. This struc-

ture would provide access to passengers heading towards the city from the airport. The CMRL had earmarked 364 sq. metres of

land for this structure and had awarded a contract for ₹8.52 crore. This facility had to be ready in eight months.

But, a source said, “There were quite a few challenges in executing the work, since the structure was coming up close to the Officers’ Training Academy (OTA). There were also some interface issues which added to the delay.”

The construction started a few months back, and sources said that it might take another six months before the station gets the new entry/exit.

Owing to the non-availability of the second entry/exit point, passengers were compelled to take a detour to reach the station.

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	37	26
Chennai Airport	38	29
Chennai City	38	28

Chennai Airport Today
37°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm. Night also will be comfortable.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be very warm. Night also will be comfortable. Chances of light rain and thundershower.

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Timings

CHENNAI		
SUNDAY, SEP. 27		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:02
RISE	18:25	SET 06:16
MONDAY, SEP. 28		
RISE	05:59	SET 18:01
RISE	19:09	SET 07:10
TUESDAY, SEP. 29		
RISE	05:59	SET 18:01
RISE	19:56	SET 08:07

THE HINDU
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RMC predicts heavy rainfall in State from September 30

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

September 2026 is likely to end on a wet note, with light to moderate rainfall expected over various parts of the State from next Sunday. Heavy rain is likely over different parts of the State from September 30.

The Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC) has forecast wet weather to continue till early October. RMC officials noted that the prevailing weather system over the Bay of Bengal is extending cloud cover over Tamil Nadu.

In its forecast, the RMC has said that light to moderate rainfall would occur over various places, including Western Ghats and southern districts, on Sunday. Rainfall would cover more northern and interior districts, including

Chennai, Vellore, Krishnagiri, Erode, and Pudukottai from Sunday.

V.R. Durai, Head, Regional Weather Forecasting Centre, said rainfall would be pronounced from September 30, as a trough along the interior districts is expected to form around the month-end. While the Nilgiris, Erode, Dharmapuri, and Krishnagiri districts are likely to record heavy rainfall in isolated places, various northern and interior districts like Madurai and Ranipet would receive scattered moderate rainfall on September 28. A similar weather trend would continue till October 2.

However, one or two places in the State may register above-normal maximum temperatures till September 30. On Saturday, Madurai airport re-

corded the day's highest temperature of 39.4 degrees Celsius in the State. Various other places like Chennai, Tiruchi, and Karur also recorded above normal temperatures.

The State has recorded below-normal rainfall during this Southwest monsoon, with a deficit of nearly 18%. Many districts, including Thanjavur, Karur, Chengalpattu, and Nagapattinam, are yet to receive their normal share of seasonal rainfall. The expected wet spell could help narrow the rainfall deficit.

The prevailing weather system has delayed the withdrawal of Southwest monsoon in some parts of the country, said Mr. Durai. The RMC has forecast that Chennai may experience near-normal maximum temperature of 35 to 36 degrees Celsius on Sunday.

South Peninsular India witnessed strongest long-term increase in drought-affected area in the country: data

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu is among the more pronounced drought hotspots in India, as a new 52-year analysis has found that South Peninsular India, the region that includes Tamil Nadu, recorded the strongest long-term increase in drought-affected area among the four broad climatic regions of the country.

The study, “Evolution of Climate Extremes Over the Indian Subcontinent Using a Revised CEI,” published in the International Journal of Climatology, analysed daily rainfall and temperature data from 1971 to 2022 to assess changes in multiple climate extremes. The researchers developed a revised India Climate Extremes Index (IndCEI) combining seven indica-

tors, including heat, drought, dry spells, and heavy rainfall.

The study found a strong positive trend in drought-affected areas over South Peninsular India, with the trend being the strongest among the four regions. While less than 10% of the region was affected by drought in much of the period before the 1990s, several years after 2000 saw more than 40% of the region under drought conditions. The researchers noted that severe and persistent drought conditions were particularly evident during the 2010s and early 2020s.

A media note accompanying the research identifies Tamil Nadu, along with Odisha and Andhra Pradesh, among the eastern coastal States where the area affected by drought



Severe and persistent drought conditions were evident during the 2010s and early 2020s. G. KARTHIKEYAN

increased by 20% to 30% during 2011-2021, compared to the 1980s.

The researchers used the Standardised Precipitation Index (SPI) to assess drought. Unlike an indicator based only on rainfall, SPI incorporates both precipitation and potential evapotranspiration, thereby capturing the influence

of increasing temperatures on water availability.

The area experiencing high maximum-temperature extremes has increased in South Peninsular India, particularly since the 2010s. The researchers said the increase in heat exposure could be linked to declining rainfall, urban heat-island effects, and broader climate change impacts.

The Heat Index, which combines temperature and humidity to indicate heat stress, also showed a steady increase over South Peninsular India. The study attributes the intensification partly to rising minimum temperatures and high humidity associated with the region's proximity to the Bay of Bengal.

Urbanisation and warmer sea-surface temperatures were also identified

as factors that could amplify heat stress. However, the study found that consecutive dry days did not show a significant long-term increase over South Peninsular India.

The researchers said the findings underline the need for region-specific adaptation, particularly drought resilience in southern India. The media note calls for a cross-sectoral response covering agriculture, water management, health, and infrastructure, alongside finer-scale monitoring to identify localised climate extremes. The study was conducted by scientists from the National Centre for Medium Range Weather Forecasting, India Meteorological Department, and Atria University, using IMD's 1° × 1° gridded rainfall and temperature datasets.

TAMILNADU HORTICULTURE DEVELOPMENT AGENCY
e- Tender Notice No. FPM2/4639/2026 Dt.25.09.2026
For and on behalf of the Governor of Tamil Nadu, e-tenders are invited from eligible contractors by the Managing Director, Tamil Nadu Horticulture Development Agency, 3rd floor, Agriculture Building Complex, Chepauk, Chennai-5 for the following work.

Sl. No	Description of work	Approximate Tender Value including 18% GST (Rs. In lakhs)
1	Providing Chain Link Fencing with RCC Post as Creation of Protective Facilities in State Coconut Nursery, Navlock, Ranipet District	114.361

e-Tender Bid Submission closing date: 14.10.2026 at 03.00 PM.
The e-tender documents, EMD details, BOQ and other tender documents which can be downloaded from the website: <https://tntenders.gov.in> free of cost. The tender inviting authority reserves the right to cancel or postpone the tender without assigning any reasons there for.
DIPRI/ 2954 /TENDER/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR, TANHODA**

**GOVERNMENT OF TELANGANA
TELANGANA HOUSING BOARD**

e-procurement Tender Notice # 04/TA/CE/THB/CURE/2026-27, Dt.26-09-2026.
The Telangana Housing Board invites the tenders on e procurement platform for the following works under Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) Contract for construction of Indiramma Indlu-EWS/LIG flats (**Phase-II**) with Stilt + 10 Floors pattern at various locations of Hyderabad City.
Design, Construction and handing over of EWS/LIG flats (**Phase-II**) of each builtup area of 528.58 Sft with (Stilt + 10) floors pattern with convention / Monolithic Concrete construction or with any innovative technology preferably (Shear wall /Precast Technology or any as approved by TGHB) with suitable foundations as per soil conditions including Civil Works, Internal Infrastructure facilities such as Internal Water Supply & Sanitary Fittings, Internal Electrification, Lifts and Fire Fighting Services as per approved Blocks Plan and type Design with 2 years defect liability period under Engineering Procurement and Construction (EPC) Contract system including GST and all taxes under the following Packages.

1	480 EWS/LIG flats at Anmangal, Hayathnagar (M) of Rangareddy District, L.B. Nagar Constituency under Package No.XI - ECV /IBM - Rs.43.20 Crores.
2	480 EWS/LIG flats at Goshamahal, Nampally (M) of Hyderabad District, Goshamahal Constituency under Package No. XII ECV /IBM - Rs.43.20 Crores.
3	480 EWS/LIG flats at Zamistanpura, RTC Depot/RTC Quarters of Hyderabad District, Musheerabad Constituency under Package No.XIII ECV /IBM - Rs.43.20 Crores.
4	480 EWS/LIG flats at Bandlaguda, Near Falaknuma, Ranga Reddy District, Chandrayangutta Constituency under Package No.XIV ECV /IBM - Rs.43.20 Crores.
5	(2nd call) 480 EWS/LIG flats at Pattigadda, Begumpet (M), Hyderabad District & 140 EWS/LIG flats at Bowenpally, Tirumalagiri (M), Hyderabad District under Package No.V - ECV/IBM - Rs.55.80 Crores.

Phase-I @ Sl. No.5
Bid Document Download Start Date & Time : 28-09-2026 @ 6.00 P.M.
Bid Document Download End Date & Time : 09-10-2026 @ 3.00 P.M.

Phase-II @ Sl. No.1 to 4
Bid Document Download Start Date & Time : 30-09-2026 @ 6.00 P.M.
Bid Document Download End Date & Time : 22-10-2026 @ 3.00 P.M.

Note : Details ,Terms & Conditions ,Corrigendum etc., can be download from the e procurement market place at <https://tender.telangana.gov.in> and also see the details in TGHB website <https://tghb.cg.gov.in> for more details to **contact Nos - 7993455785** (Deputy Chief Engineer), **9160441255** (Dy.EE & TA to Chief Engineer), **9908218228** (Dy.EE & TA to Chief Engineer) and **9908523218** (Chief Engineer).
Sd/- Deputy Chief Engineer, TGHB, Hyd

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SIR MUTTRA VENKATASUPRA RAO
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THE HINDU
WELLNESS SERIES

A webinar on
Don't Miss a Beat: Prevent, Detect & Treat Heart Disease
September, 28, 2026 | 11:30 AM Onwards

Prof. Dr Ajith Pillai
HOD - Interventional Cardiologist, Kauvery Hospital, Radial Road, Chennai

Dr Arunkumar Krishnasamy
Senior Consultant, Cardiothoracic Surgeon - Kauvery Hospital, Alwarpet, Chennai

Dr Mahadevan V
Senior Consultant - Interventional Cardiology & Diabetology, Kauvery Hospital, Vadapalani, Chennai

Dr Javid Raja
Consultant - Paediatric Cardiac Surgeon, Kauvery Hospital, Heartcity, Trichy

Meenakshy S
Principal Correspondent, The Hindu (Moderator)

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THE HINDU

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WALK-IN
GENERAL

FINANCE

A Family Business office situated off Howrah's Road in a residential locality requires

One Assistant Manager / Deputy Manager / Manager + Accounts.

❖ **Qualification - B.Com or above preferred**

❖ **Job contents - Banking (offline), Going to Banks, Writing cheques, paying bills.**

Pure accounts function. Financial knowledge not essential.

❖ **Salary above market**

❖ **Age: Around 50 years**

Email address: wtdrecruitment@gmail.com
Ph: 93636 12881 (no WhatsApp messages)

WANTED ACCT Retd/ Part/ full time, know Tally, GST. qza300@gmail.com

WANTED YOUNG Male Accountant with very Good Experience in Tally & Excel/Call 044-28158932, +91-9840823235

ACCOUNTANT 5-6 yrs Exp Tally, GST, TDS & Excel Kwidge. Alwarthirunagar, Kattur Opp Veltech Clg 9884343104

CA/CA final/CMA with Tally and advance excel experience not exceeding 30 years Interested applicants shall email their updated CV with expected salary to info.arubi@gmail.com

A LEADING Glass Co.Req Account Asst with Tally Knowledge & Billing Female @Arumbakam 978999774/7845726288

WANTED ACCOUNTANT, Manager for Petrol Bunk @ Maduravoyal Ct: 9444046587

GENERAL

GRAPHIC DESIGNER, Interior Designer, Autocad, CNC wood carving Machine Operator. Ct: 99419 11116

BANK OFFERS work from home Min 2L P.M Rtd,Nr,NRE,Auditors. 9841619586

GENERAL

WANTED MANAGER for FL3-Bar in the Hotel at Maraimalai Nagar. Work experience in the Bar is must. Age limit 40 to 50 years. Timing afternoon 2pm to midnight 12pm. Salary Rs.4.5Lakhs/ per annum. Ct: 94452 99181

REQUIRED OPTICAL Sales & Account Assistant (Part time/Full time) with Tally & GST Knowledge - Minimum 2 Years Experience Need.Ph: 9789975393, Email: visioncareadyar@gmail.com

WANTED GOVT Bankers Housewives Retired and VRS. Contact: 9176694966

JOB -OFFICER Role/ Team Leader/ Sr. Administrative Manager with Fixed Salary. upto Rs.72,000 - Age 40+ Pref. VRS / Register. Ct: 9600155077

WANTED: EXPERIENCED candidates aged 55+ for Quality roles (DME/ BE) in an auto parts manufacturing company at Gerugambakkam. Call:9841013891

TELE-CALLER & Office asst. wanted min 3yrs exp good salary location Adyar for reputed Builder.63794 11008

SEEKING AN experienced, responsible, trustworthy and efficient Lady PA / Admin Manager of above 30 years, to work for a professional artiste in a non-corporate environment. Requirements: Multi-tasking skills, Proficiency in computer, 6 days a week, Location: Kilpauk, Salary will be commensurate with experience. Apply: execsec@ca.com

WANTED MACHINE Building Manager to Lead our Machine Building Team in Chennai. B.E/B.Tech-Mechanical Engineering 12 to 18yrs Experience in Machine Building / Special Purpose Machines SPM Manufacturing, Machine tools, industrial automation or High-Volume Manufacturing would be preferred. Mail: r.sampathkumar@avocarbon.com

REPUTED MANFC. unit @ Ambattur recg. Exp. Ship Supervisor, Store Keeper, Draftsman with Mech. Diploma/ITI & Office Asst. with Accounts knowld. Tally/Excel (age 40-45) Call: 8838462544, kalpanaavarshin@gmail.com

WANTED EXP Sale Mktng Manager & Telecallers for Leading Co. 9884111745

GENERAL

WANTED 24 Crore Entrepreneur Hundred Crore Project Free Advance Free Collateral Please Visit Register welargescalentrepreneur.com

Executive Culinary Applications

Vacancy for a Bakery/ Confectionary/ Beverage chef or an Expert cookie, biscuit baker with a good knowledge even in candy making for a food flavourings manufacturing company located in Vanagaram. **Ct: 73977 04699**

RETO PERSONS for Admin, Follow-up & Business Dvp. qza300@gmail.com

WANTED DIPLOMA Civil Engineer @ Chennai Mini 3 to 5yrs Exp 9884603345

SALES MANAGER 10yr Exp CNC Machine Sales Loc: Chennai, Coimbatore & Service Engineer 3-4yrs Exp CNC Machine Service Loc: Chennai 9884943104

WANTED - WELFARE OFFICER for a leading Manufacturing Company. Qual: MSW / MBA / MHRM / BLM / MLM; Exp: 3 - 5 Years. Contact: M/s. Fritzmeier Mothersen Cabin Engineering Pvt. Ltd. 112, Singadivakkam Village, Attuputhur Post, Kancheepuram, Tamil Nadu - 631561. Email: sivakumar.h.r.fritzmeier.motherson.com

Experienced Sales Officers With 2 Wheeler. Walk In Interview On 28.09.2026 Between 11.00 AM To 6.00 PM Trishla Agencies 1/128, 3rd Lane Shastri Nagar 1 Street, Trichy, Chennai 600 017 **Call: 9500072625 Email: trishlaagencies@gmail.com**

GENERAL

RECEPTIONIST WANTED with experience for an advertising agency in T.Nagar. Email: resume@sreshia.us

NURSE PHARMACIST Clinic,MktgExe Driver Book Co.M/F Velachery9840125695

REG FRESH/ Exp Accts. Resort Manager/ General Admin Maintenance Civil Engineer. Near, Skywalk Chennai. Email: trinitysquare2000@gmail.com

5-YRS EXPD Qtd Civil supervisor can handle independently 9841040129

SECURITY & HK Agency Req Exp Adm. Opns, Mktg Exe. 98410 62646 / 44233

CIVIL PROJECT Engineer/ Manager/ Sales Executive 10 to 15 Years Experience in Resi Construction 9342323200

REG STORE Manager&Store Execu. Exp In Saree,Fashion Gud Communication Tamil&English@Injambakkam 9566161112

WANTED FEMALE Staff With Exp Tally & English age below 35yrs Knwlg Gud sly mail with photo @ bala1010april@gmail.com , 99438 59196

WE ARE HIRING

A luxury hardware showroom at ANNA SALAI (Nandanam) requires the following candidates.

SHOWROOM MANAGER -1 No / Male/Female

Minimum 3 years experience.

MARKETING EXECUTIVE -2 Nos / Male

Minimum 2 years experience.

OFFICE ADMIN cum TELECALLER -1 No / Female

Minimum 1 year experience.

Qualification : Any Degree with Good communication skills in English.

Whatsapp only 99439-91159 (Don't Call) surya@sunventuresindia.com

LOGISTICS

WANTED ASST. Manager - Export & Import. Qualification: Degree / MBA. Preferred: Minimum 5 Years Exp. in Fragrance/Chemical Industry. Knowledge: SEZ/Customs Rules and Regulations, Export & Import Customs Clearance. CTC: 6-7.5 Lpa. Send your resume to Quintessence Fragrances Pvt Ltd, MEPZ-SEZ, Chennai. Email : yuvrajjan.dasaratna@quintessencein.com

MARKETING

VACANCY FOR Experienced Sales representative for upcoming Paint Industry Chennai. Ct:9353791475

BUSINESS EXECUTIVE required for a 25yrs experienced Construction Material Supply Company. Ct: 9884972235

WANTED MARKETING Managers & Telecallers ers #1 USA BRAND HUMMER 9884444411

PVT LTD School Prod MFG CO.Manali Chennai BDM Strong in Communication Digital Govt Orders Stry 6LPFA+ writopanel@gmail.com Ct: 90033 39381 / 044 - 26547304 / 05 / 06

MEDICAL

AYURVEDIC DOCTORS Wanted BAMS/MD. Experienced / Freshers Ct: 7200758899

REQ LADY Dentist BDS Full Time 10AM to 8PM Sal-Hnc Nandanam 9176210077

SECRETARIAL

FEMALE OFFICE Secretary Age Bel 40, good English- Computer knowledge Tondiarpet, 9 -6pm, Salary 18,000 plus . Whatsapp resume:9600009999

TECHNICAL

SITE ENGINEER 5 + yrs exp, capable of handling the site. 98409 67070

1.ELECTRICAL ENGINEER (POSTING KANCHIPURAM): B.E/B.Tech (EEE) with valid C Licence, preferably 5 to 10 years of experience in electrical Maintenance.2.ELECTRICAL SUPERVISOR-C LICENCE HOLDER(POSTING KANCHIPURAM): Diploma/B.E/B.Tech in EEE with a valid C Licence, preferably with experience in electrical maintenance.Apply: Kwaliti Milk Foods Ltd. / hr@kwalitimilkfoods.com

Construction Company Requires CIVIL ENGINEER Experienced : 5 YEARS & ABOVE E-mail: Info@chetna.net Ct: 9884454486

TECHNICAL

SITE ENGINEERS for Industrial Shed, Oragadam min 5yr exp. 98409 67070

WANTED EXP Civil Engineers with Min 1-5 Yrs Exp in Oil Industries Project Min Sal:40,000/- Wanted Exp Accts Manager in civil const. company with Min 10 Yrs Exp Min Sal: 50,000/- Mechanical Eng with 5 Yrs Exp in Fabrication work. Sal:40,000/- Autocad and Draftsman Exp in Civil const. Min Sal:40,000/- Apply to : ps.recruitment2026@gmail.com Ct: 90033 39381 / 044 - 26547304 / 05 / 06

TECHNICAL

WANTED CIVIL Site Engineers - Experience 5 to 10 years. Location: Chennai. Contact: 9791939505. Mail: info.bhchennai@gmail.com

Required CIVIL ENGINEERS QUANTITY SURVEYORS for site and office with 5 years experience. Power Builders 9940012344

TECHNICAL

STRUCTURAL DESIGN engineers well versed in StaadPro, Excel,Word, CAD Apply dpcinfatech@gmail.com

VMC SETTER, CMM Prog, Accounts Exec, CNC Operator Ambattur 9884495521

WANTED CIVIL Site Supervisor Chennai 5 Yrs Exp. 9597088433/ 9790994080

WALK - IN

BFSI CO Reg. Age 40+ M/F New Branch @ T.Nagar, Salary +Inc. 9884558989

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Classifieds Customer Care
Phone: 044-28576342 Toll Free: 1800 102 4161
or contact your nearest Authorised Space Sellers

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Classifieds Sunday, Wednesday & Friday Combo Offer:
At just 35% extra a Situations Vacant Advertisement in the Sunday Classifieds can be repeated under the same heading the following Wednesday and Friday in the Classifiedsmart columns.

REAL ESTATE

INDEX OF REAL ESTATE
ARCHITECTS
BUILDER'S REQUIREMENTS
BRICKS/CONCRETE BLOCKS
BUILDING CONTRACTORS
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MARBLE
PAINTING CONTRACTORS
CONSULTANTS
HOME DECOR
PUBLIC NOTICE
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RESIDENTIAL
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RESIDENTIAL FLAT-RESALE
RESIDENTIAL HOUSE
RESIDENTIAL LAND
TIME SHARE
GENERAL
BUYING
COMMERCIAL BUILDING
WANTED COMM. Rental Income Building Budget 2Cr-20Cr Azzets: 8438823345
COMMERCIAL LAND
ECR 2 to 5 Acres Land for Layout. Dr.G Realstates Pvt Ltd 9791176865
5-10 ACRES Required for Commercial Use. Site must be on OMR Main Rd. LBR-Lakshmi Balaji Realty 9841098170
GENERAL
VILLIVAKKAM and Ayanavaram & Perambur 30ft Rd 2 Grounds.NRI.Ct: 9840915046
REG LAND up to 5 Acres,Clear Title- Kelambakkam,Thirupurur, Kalavakkam,Main/40ft RD. Direct owners preferred. Immediate Buy. Call 9841095556
RESIDENTIAL
WE URGENTLY Need Resale Flats & Land @ Velachery 100ft Road in and around Immediate Seller. Ct:9566903737
NEED 1.5-4GR Ashok Nagar-T Nagar Minm 30ft Rd House Or Land 9840055888

COMMERCIAL LAND

LAND FOR SALE 6000 Sq.ft Residential / Commercial Land Prime Location at MTH Road, Villivakkam Next to HDFC Bank

63747 35955 95519 17102

300 meters to Anna Nagar, 500 meters from Villivakkam (Nadha Muni) Metro Station

ADYAR K.B.NAGAR Commercial Land 26Grounds for Sale>Contact- 80566 67670

AMBATTUR INDUSTRIAL Estate 6700 Sq.ft. Industrial Space for Sale. Near Main Road. Contact : 98842 47216

OMR THORAIPAKAM Opp ASV Tower 4G 3.5C 9841971947/ 6374401577/ 42337779

ECR UTHANDI Main Road 2Gr Commercial Land Ct: 9962422255 / 8939677444

✓ **VADAPALANI 4GR** on Main Rd for Hospital,Retail.NoBrk Sultana 8428499879

GUINDY SIDCO INDL ESTATE NEAR RAILWAY / METRO & BUS STAND 3.5 GROUND INDUSTRIAL COMMERCIAL LAND FOR SALE. EAST FACING, 2 SIDES ROAD SUITABLE FOR OFFICE, IT,IES, FACTORY & LOGISTICS 98416 98803

VELACHERY - ADAMBAKKAM Main Road 4 Grounds Corner Plot with Good Frontage Cosmic Properties 90907 50000

✓ **3 Acres - Pappambakkam**, Tiruvallur near Ecobok & Hyundai Glovis. Suitable for Industrial Ct: 9445706542

ASHOK NAGAR, 2 Grounds, Commercial Land for sale. Contact: 9600178756

MADHURAVOYAL COM/RES land 12 Grounds, 40ft Road close ,Poonamallee High Rd, Dmost Realtors : 9043855858

T.NAGAR SOUTH West Boag Rd 5550ft 2BHK 12000sqft Bldg 50ft Rq 984018780

OMR SHOLINGANALUR Bhd TCS Srusen 86rd 24ft Rd 1.20Cr/Grd. 9677031181

NORT FACING PLOT FOR SALE: 3138 SqFt, near Guduvanchery Bus Terminus. Contact: 980297542.

TMK@GST VANDALUR On M.Rd Opp-Railway Stn 1 Acre Land Sale. 9840048804

PADAPPAL NAVALUR 1.37 acres for sale. 9790756129/9789052036

WASHERMENPET 10000SFT 11Cr. Rent Income 4.5L/Mh Raj NoBrk 9840326659

INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITY Ambattur 1100 Bldg North Phase 5 Gds 1100 Bldg Built-up area 140 hp +60hp Main Road 2.5 Cr per Ground. Rental income 5 L. Broker Excuse. Cash Parly- 9840047476

AVADI INDUS LAND 4.12 Acre 10K Sq Bldg Corner 50KV Rs.29Cr 9884088660

FARMHOUSE / LAND / RESORTS

OFF ECR 7Km, 25.5 Acres S.Owner 11.55Cr. Ct: Vasudha Estates 8807766077

MAHABALIPURAM GATED Cmnty Eb Water Line 4.3Gr NF Rs.2200/Gr 9677080055

RESIDENTIAL FLAT - NEW

Adyar KB Nagar 4BHK, 2650sqft, 1080 UDS, 4Bath, Poja, Lift till Terrace, 2 Free CCP, Under Cons.95511 42288

KODAMBAKKAM, LUXURIOUS 3BHK, 1500 & 1440 sqft, 14K / sft Base Price. Possession Nov 2026. Ct: 93429 12618

T.NAGAR BRAND New Flat, 2153 Sqft, 3 BHK For Sale. 9994053640

KK NGR 2BHK CCP, Lift, Gym,Terrace Garden, CCTV 1.62Cr. Ph:7094222211

SALIGRAMAM NEAR Arunachala Road 3BHK Flat for sale. 996209999

AVADI New Flat for sale 3BHK Flats 1421sqft, 1361sft with ccp. Lift in Rajbai Nagar. Feb 2027 Completion. Ct: Sreevari Constructions 9840440568

RAMAPURAM New Customizable 2, 3, 4 BHK flats 77-L onwards.78100 25909

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR NEW 2, 3 BHK for sale 87-L onwards. Ct: 78100 25909

VIRUGAMBAKKAM NATESAN NR 3BHK 1490Sft Lux Appt. 9841661060, 9840062878

CHITLAPAKKAM NEW 2BHK 820 -1001sf Rera Appd Ready Occup. 9884049612

PERAMBUR AGARAM 2, 3BHK 1130-1541 Sq. Ft. SCC 967726755, 9445217978

VALASARAVAKKAM 3BHK Stilt+5flrs NR Eb off Nairan Promoters 9441319114

MUTTUAKADU ECR Brand New Flat 3600Sft Rs.2.70Cr.Ct: 9840245678

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR BOOK Now for Offer Price 2BHK 1050Sft/Lift CCP, Near Metro.SRK CONSTRUCTIONS: 9808397355 / 9840957621

MANAPAKKAM: MODERN 4BHK Premium Homes at IPS Colony, Minutes from Trade Centre, MIOT Hospitals, Metro & Airport. Ready to Occupy. Starting From Rs. 1.85Cr. Ct: 044-49494485

RAMAPURAM RAYALA Nagar 3-BHK Deluxe Flat for Sale. Ready to Occupy Only One Flat Available. Sakthi Foundation. 98848 43882

10MINS FROM Adyar Ready to Occupy Premium 2 & 3 BHK Apartments at Pe. Rungudi, OMR (Behind World Trade Centre). Special Price Rs. 1.19 Cr Onwards. Ct: 044-49494506

PALLAVARAM: PREMIUM Ready-to-move 2 & 3 BHK Apartments from Rs. 58L. Possession in just 10 days! Hurry, limited units! (862 Sqft to 1431 Sq.ft). Ct: 044-49494517

PADUR, OMR Main Road/ Sea-Facing 3 BHK Apts. 1700 sq.ft. Opp. Chettinad Healthcare Rs. 1.1Cr Onwards/ Handover in just 10 Days! Call: 044-49494537

3BHK ARCOT Road 1664sf 482 Uds 2Bty At N.F. Gated Commn 1.82C 9500063091

THORAIPAKKAM: READY to Occupy 2 BHK from Rs. 86L. Handover in just 15 days (1033 sqft to 1199 sqft). Ct: 044-46184410

10MINS FROM Porur Premium 2 & 3 BHK Apartments from Just Rs. 68L Onwards at Kovur. Call: 044-49494554

RESIDENTIAL FLAT - NEW

RAJAKILPAKKAM 1970SFT New 3BHK 1Flat per Floor CCTV, LIFT, Independent CCP, Video Calling Door 9840598490

VADAPALANI / NANGANALUR 2/3BR 1.5C BrNew PVKM 2/3BR TNR 3BR 9962192721

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited for and on behalf of the President of India for the following works:- **Tender No.: EL/CON/536.**

Name of the work: Development of sports infrastructure at CLW, Chittaranjan.

Contract Type: Works. **Tender Value (GST inclusive) Rupees:** ₹ 21,99,003.57/- (Rupees Twenty-one lakhs ninety-nine thousand three and paise fifty-seven only). **Cost of tender Document Rupees:** Not Applicable. **Earnest Money Rupees:** ₹ 44,000/- (Rupees Forty-four thousand only). **Period of completion (In Months):** 05 (Five Months). **Date of closing:** 12.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **NOTE:** Complete details can be seen on the Railway's website: www.ireps.gov.in.

PRG/502/ Dy.CEE/M/CLW/Chittaranjan
Visit us on: www.facebook.com/clwrailways

Request for Proposal for Comprehensive Project Consultancy Services for Elimination of Level Crossings

Tender Notice No.: CPM-GS-MLG-PC2-2026-08; Date: 25-09-2026. Open tender through e-tendering system is invited from experienced and reputed contractors (s)/firm(s) for the following works. **Tender No. : CPM-GS-MLG-PC2-2026-08** **Name of work:** Request for Proposal (RFP) for providing Project consultant (PC) for providing "Comprehensive Consultancy services from the stage of Feasibility Study & DPR preparation for elimination of Level Crossing gates in NF Railway by constructing ROB and/ RUB/LHS/Other Structures/ Road Diversion as required including Detailed Design of required components of finalised scheme, Tendering for execution of works as per finalised scheme, Techno-Manual Consultancy, Processing & Facilitation for land acquisition, Project supervision Services/Project Management Consultancy etc. for execution of work till closure of level crossings/Defect Liability Period of execution contract". Approx. Value: ₹89,74,67,325.18. **E-tender will be closed at 15:30 hrs.** on 20-10-2026 and **will be opened at 15:30 hrs.** on 20-10-2026. For Details please visit www.ireps.gov.in

CPM/GS/Maligaon
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TAMIL NADU HOUSING BOARD

SPECIAL PROJECT DIVISION I

EXTENSION OF TIME
NOTIFICATION FOR E-TENDER CUM E-AUCTION

Tamil Nadu Housing Board, Special Project Division - I proposed to sell the Public purpose Site, Commercial Purpose Site, Nursery School Site, and Primary School Site at Kilimudalambedu Phase-II Scheme, Thiruvallur District by inviting application through E-Tender cum E-Auction for the period from **25.08.2026 to 24.09.2026** and the same has been Extended upto **08.10.2026**.

Please visit the website <https://tntenders.gov.in> to download the details regarding, Code No, Plot No, Plot Extent, Upset price, Auction date & other terms and conditions as per the schedule mentioned below.

Note: 1. To apply in <https://tntenders.gov.in> website, the Digital Signature Certificate (DSC key) is mandatory and the same shall be purchased from the appropriate vendor.

2. The detailed online registration procedure is available in the portal <https://tntenders.gov.in>. Click on bidders manual kit on the home page (bottom right corner).

Address:-
Executive Engineer & Administrative Officer (i/c), Special Project Division I,TNHb,
Tamil Nadu Housing Board Office Complex,
1stMain Road, CIT Nagar, Chennai – 600 035.
Cell. - 99404 98968.

Executive Engineer & Administrative Officer (i/c) Special Project Division I

DIPR/2952/Tender/2026

STORES E-PROCUREMENT

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 05/2026; Dated: 23-09-2026. E-tenders are invited for the following work:-

Description of works	Tender Quantity	Tender Due Date
SN. 1, Tender No. 04265210		
Supply of 6 quad cable, 1.4 mm dia copper conductor, polythene insulated screen wire /strip galvanized steel armoured, underground Jelly filled as per specification no. RDSO/SPN/TC/72/ 2007 with amendment no 1 or latest.	13 KM	14-10-2026 (15.30 Hrs.)
SN. 2, Tender No. 04265209		
6 Quad cable 0.9 MM dia copper conductor, polythene insulated, Aluminium screened armoured underground jelly field Cable as per RDSO Specification No. IRS.TC 30/ 2005 (Ver-1) Amdt 1 & 5 or latest.	142 KM	14-10-2026 (15.30 Hrs.)
SN. 3, Tender No. 04265207		
Underground armoured unscreened Railway signalling cable, PVC insulated, copper conductor, Spec. No. IRS.S: 63/2014(Rev.4.0) or latest of Size: 12 Core x 1.5 Sq.mm .	374 KM	14-10-2026 (15.30 Hrs.)
SN. 4, Tender No. 04265206		
Underground Power Cable, PVC Insulated Unscreened Armoured, Aluminium Conductor for Railway Application, Spec : IRS-S-63/2014 (Rev.4.0) & IS : 1554 (Part -1) or latest, SIZE : 2C X 25 Sq. mm	105 KM	14-10-2026 (15.30 Hrs.)

NOTE:- For full details of Tender Notice and Tender Documents, **Tenderer may log on to the website (www.ireps.gov.in)** prospective bidder who intend to participate in above tenders are required to log in themselves with the above website and submit their offer electronically, if they are already registered with **IREPS**. In case they are not registered with **IREPS**, they are advised to attend class-III Digital Signature Certificate from the certifying agencies under Govt. of India IT Act 2000 and participate in the above tender.

Principal Chief Materials Manager/Con/Maligaon
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(Construction Organisation)
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Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

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FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR Young World THE HINDU

INSTITUTE OF LIVER & BILIARY SCIENCES (ILBS)

"CAREER OPPORTUNITIES"
Faculty & Non-Faculty Posts
(ILBS/Careers/5/26)

Addendum: In continuation to advertisement dated 30.08.2026, applications are invited on the prescribed online application form to fill up the following additional posts on contract basis for a period of 'four years' which can be extended based on performance:

S. No.	Name of Post	Number of Post
1.	Additional Professor (Nuclear Medicine)	1-UR
2.	Additional Professor (Pulmonary Medicine)	1-UR
3.	Additional Professor (Nephrology)	1-UR
4.	Additional Professor (Liver Transplant Surgery)	1-UR
5.	Associate Professor (Nephrology)	2-UR
6.	Assistant Professor (Clinical Hematology)	1-UR
7.	Consultant (Anaesthesia) Grade IV	2-UR, 1-OBC
8.	Consultant (Hepatology) Grade IV	2-UR, 1-OBC
9.	Consultant (Medical Oncology) Grade I, III	2-UR
10.	Consultant (Cardiology) Grade I, II, III, IV	2-UR, 1-OBC, 1-ST
11.	Casualty Medical Officer	1-OBC, 1*-SC
12.	Principal (Nursing)	1-UR
13.	Assistant Registrar	1-UR
14.	Technical Executive (Surgery/ OT)	1-UR
15.	Senior Executive (IT)	1-UR
16.	Resident Hospital Administrator	2-UR, 2*-OBC, 1*-SC

*including backlog.

The last date of receipt of applications is 18th October, 2026. For further details and other posts of faculty and non-faculty, please visit <http://www.ilbs.in>.

Head Operations (Non Medical), ILBS

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CSIR-STRUCTURAL ENGINEERING RESEARCH CENTRE, CHENNAI

(वैज्ञानिक तथा औद्योगिक अनुसंधान परिषद् Council of Scientific & Industrial Research)

सीएसआईआर परिसर CSIR Campus, तमिऴुनऴु Taramani, चेन्नै Chennai - 600 113, भारत INDIA
दूरभाष Tel : 044 - 2254 9108 / 4777, 22541238 फॅक्स Fax : 044-22542211
ई-मेल E-mail : puroff.serc@csir.res.in

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना Notice Inviting Tender

निदेशक, सीएसआईआर-एसईआरसी द्वारा प्रतिष्ठित एवं सक्षम बोलीदाताओं से "अत्याधुनिक वास्तविक काल अंकीय संकर नियंत्रण प्रणाली तथा सर्वो मोटर ड्राइव युक्त विद्युत चरित्रों की आपूर्ति, स्थापना, संचालन में लाता, परीक्षण, प्रशिक्षण एवं प्रलेखीकरण" हेतु कोटेशन आमंत्रित करते हैं।

The Director, CSIR-SERC invites quotation from reputed and competent Bidders for the 'Supply, Installation, Commissioning, Testing, Training and Documentation for **State-of-the-Art Real Time Digital Hybrid Control System and Electrical Winches with Servo Motor Drive**'.

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Tender Document can be downloaded free of cost directly from the GeM Portal vide GeM Bid No.GEM/2026/B/8020830 dated 11.09.2026. A copy of the Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) is also available on CSIR-SERC website: <http://www.serc.res.in>.

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1	बालूघाट कलस्टर सं०-01 (कमला नदी)	27.09.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से	03.10.2026 अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक		14.10.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से	14.10.2026 को अपराह्न 01:00 बजे तक
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I,BARIRAH HUNKU LI W/o. Mr. Badri Bilal (46 yrs), R/o. Old no 261, New No 16, 2nd Main Road, Natesan Nagar Virugambakkam, Chennai - 600092 do hereby confirm that my correct format of my name is Given Name is : BARIRAH HUNKU and Surname is : LI vide affidavit dated 23.09.2026

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CM YK A CH-CHE

Ex-IPS officer seeks inquiry on Rai's role in donation theft

The Hindu Bureau
LUCKNOW

Social activist and former IPS officer Amitabh Thakur on Saturday wrote to the Uttar Pradesh Director General of Police, demanding a detailed investigation into the role of former Ram Temple Trust general secretary Champat Rai, and his legal responsibility in the Ram Temple donation theft case.

"According to Champat Rai's statement in the charge sheet, he received a video and messages related to the alleged theft on WhatsApp... he was also shown a video of money being taken out of the counting room. I demand it be investigated when and in what manner Champat Rai informed the police or competent authorities, and why there was a delay in registering the FIR," Mr. Thakur told *The Hindu*.

"I also demanded that Champat Rai's legal responsibility be determined on the basis of the facts emerging during investigation, and that necessary action be taken in accordance with law," he said.

Cong. questions probe into Ram Temple donation theft

Why have key Trust functionaries, including Champat Rai and Anil Mishra, been made witnesses, asks Jairam; he questions PM Modi's silence, seeks impartial investigation under SC's supervision

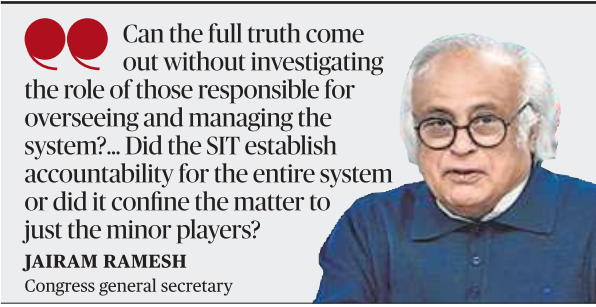
The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Saturday questioned the scope of the Special Investigation Team (SIT) probe into the alleged *chadhawa chori* (theft of devotees' offerings) at the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya, asking why key functionaries responsible for the temple's management had not been named as accused in the case.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh also questioned Prime Minister Narendra Modi's silence on the issue and asked him to respond.

The Congress's communications chief questioned the 21-day delay between the reported recovery of ₹2.25 lakh from a bathroom on June 4 and the registration of a First Information Report on June 25. Mr. Ramesh sought an impartial investigation under the supervision of the Supreme Court.

In a post on social media



Can the full truth come out without investigating the role of those responsible for overseeing and managing the system?... Did the SIT establish accountability for the entire system or did it confine the matter to just the minor players?

JAIRAM RAMESH
Congress general secretary

platform X, Mr. Ramesh said the charge sheet had recorded that a video of the cash recovery was sent to the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust general secretary Champat Rai on June 4, and that he was shown the CCTV footage on the following day.

"If the CCTV footage, recovery and identification of suspicious employees had already come to light, why was there such a delay in initiating criminal action?" Mr. Ramesh said.

The Congress leader also questioned why Mr. Rai, trustee Anil Mishra, and construction in-charge Gopal Rao had been made

witnesses rather than accused in the case.

According to Mr. Ramesh, the charge sheet records 105 instances of offerings being removed during the counting process. One accused was allegedly seen removing money on 85 occasions, he said.

"Can the full truth of the offering theft come out without investigating the role of those responsible for overseeing and managing the system?" Mr. Ramesh asked.

He also questioned the decision to restrict the case to eight accused despite the SIT examining CCTV footage, digital communi-

cations, and financial records.

"Did the SIT establish accountability for the entire system or did it confine the matter to just the minor players?" the Congress leader said.

The alleged theft concerned offerings made by devotees and the investigation should therefore establish responsibility beyond those directly accused of removing the cash, Mr. Ramesh said.

'Probe BJP, RSS links'

He also asked whether the investigation had examined any possible links to the senior leadership of the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS).

"The case cannot be considered closed until the real responsibility for the theft of offerings made in the name of Lord Ram is fixed," Mr. Ramesh said, calling for an impartial and transparent investigation under the Supreme Court's supervision.

Mamata aide Kunal Ghosh attacked; ex-CM alleges bid to disrupt party meetings

Shiv Sahay Singh
Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

Belegghata MLA and Mamata All India Trinamool Congress (Mamata AITC) leader Kunal Ghosh was on Saturday attacked when he was visiting Serampore in West Bengal's Hooghly to participate in a public meeting addressed by former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee.

Mr. Ghosh's vehicle was blocked by a mob in Uttarpara and eggs and stones were thrown at the car. It was also attacked with sticks even as slogans were raised against Mr. Ghosh.

He suffered injuries in the attack and could not participate in the meeting called by his party chairperson, Mr. Ghosh said, adding that the attack forced him to return to Kolkata.

The MLA visited Bhabani Bhawan, the West Bengal Police Headquarters here, where he tried to meet senior police officers over the attack.

"We had fought in the court for over 15 days just



Risky ride: Kunal Ghosh's car was vandalised at Uttarpara, West Bengal, on Saturday. ANI

to get permission for the rally. The whole road [to Serampore] has been blocked and there is no sign of the police," Ms. Banerjee said. It was extremely unfair as party workers faced attacks despite seeking permission, she said. "Why should we have to approach the court every single time simply to hold a political meeting? The courts already have an enormous number of cases and responsibilities," Ms. Banerjee said.

Attempts were made to disrupt the gathering, the former West Bengal Chief Minister said. "If you [the BJP] have genuinely won in

the elections, then why are you not allowing Opposition parties to hold rallies?" Ms. Banerjee said. She had been placed under house arrest after the Assembly election and was not allowed to venture out, she alleged.

State BJP president Samik Bhattacharya said the people throwing eggs were not associated with the BJP.

While Ms. Banerjee has addressed public meetings in Kolkata after her party's Assembly poll debacle, the Sreerampore rally was the first occasion on which she spoke to her supporters in other districts.

India slams Pak's 'falsehoods' and 'deceit' at UNGA

Press Trust of India
UNITED NATIONS

Describing Pakistan as a "puppet" regime, India criticised the country's "falsehoods" and "deceit" at the United Nations (UN), warning that continued terrorism by Islamabad will have consequences.

India exercised its Right of Reply on Friday night, after Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif used the UN General Assembly (UNGA) podium to credit U.S. President Donald Trump for his "timely intervention" in the 2025 conflict with India, and again raised the Kashmir issue in his address to the world body.

Petal Gahlot, First Secretary in the Permanent Mission of India to the UN, said, "We heard some hypocritical homilies about democratic rights and human values from a regime whose capital at this very moment is being fortified against its own people."

"We are confident that this Assembly will recognise Pakistan and its policies for what they really are; not what its represen-

J&K is an integral part of India and will always remain so, says First Secretary Petal Gahlot

tative mendaciously projects it to be. Reiterating falsehoods year after year does not make them true. Pakistan's terrorism, deceit and duplicity will neither benefit it nor the world," she said.

Criticising Mr. Sharif for raising the Kashmir issue, Ms. Gahlot said Jammu and Kashmir was an integral part of the country. "And will always remain so."

Criticising Pakistan for its "long-standing practice" of cross-border terrorism, Ms. Gahlot said India had demonstrated last year that "terrorists will have nowhere to run, nowhere to hide."

India had launched Operation Sindoor on May 7, 2025, targeting terror infrastructure in Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied Kashmir, in retaliation for the Pahalgam attack of April 22, 2025, which killed 26 civilians.

A.P. govt. refuses to defend Centre's changes to trans rights law in court

Abhinav Lakshman
NEW DELHI

The National Democratic Alliance (NDA)-ruled Andhra Pradesh government, in an affidavit in the Supreme Court, has refused to defend the Centre's controversial 2026 amendments to the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act.

The court is presently hearing at least a dozen petitions challenging the law. The State, in the affidavit filed in August, told the court that it had no role in enacting the Act, and that the constitutional validity of the law is "primarily a matter for the Union of India".

The Centre had introduced amendments to the law earlier this year, removing provisions that guaranteed transgender people the right to their "self-perceived gender identity" and limiting the definition of a "transgender person" to physiological characteristics. The amendments triggered widespread protests across the country and led members of the government's National Council for Transgender Persons to resign



Contentious case: The Centre's amendments to the Transgender Persons Act had triggered widespread protests. NAGARA GOPAL

over the changes, even as Parliament passed the Bill and the government notified it.

'No discrimination'

With the Centre yet to respond to the challenges to the law, Andhra Pradesh, ruled by the Telugu Desam Party (TDP), a BJP ally, has told the top court that it has "not taken any independent action that is discriminatory towards transgender persons".

Interestingly, while the Bill was being discussed in the Lok Sabha on March 24, TDP MP Byreddy Shabari was among the MPs of the NDA who had supported it, by raising purported

complaints that people were falsely adopting a transgender identity for begging at traffic signals.

In its affidavit, Andhra Pradesh provided data on the number of transgender persons certified across the State, showing that of the total 3,750 applications for transgender identity cards, 3,233 had been issued certificates, 403 had been "filtered", and 114 applications were pending.

Uttarakhand in favour

On the other hand, the BJP-ruled government in Uttarakhand has defended the 2026 amendments to the law, saying that matters related to rights and health-

care needs of transgender people are "influenced by social norms and existing systems", in addition to government regulations.

The Uttarakhand government has submitted that the amended law's operation in the State had not resulted in "any denial, dilution, erosion or abridgement of the rights of transgender persons", adding that the process of "identification, certification, welfare, and rehabilitation" of transgender persons has continued.

While introducing the Bill in Parliament, the Centre and BJP-led NDA MPs insisted that retaining the principle of self-determination of gender identity would lead to people "falsely" claiming to be transgender in order to claim social welfare benefits. This came even as Opposition MPs objected to the amendments, arguing that the right to self-determination of gender identity was recognised by the Supreme Court in its landmark NALSA judgment of 2014 and that removing this right was an "attack on Constitutional morality" and the dignity of transgender persons.

JD(U) backs call for giving more time to SC/ST MPs in House

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

A day after *The Hindu* news report on Union Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi's letter to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla flagging concerns over inadequate speaking time for Scheduled Caste (SC) and Scheduled Tribe (ST) Members of Parliament during discussions on key legislation, Janata Dal (United) national general secretary Shyam Rajak endorsed the remarks, saying Dalit representatives should be given sufficient opportunities to voice issues in Parliament.

"Jitan Ram Manjhi is a senior Minister and also a prominent leader of the Dalit community. He must have felt this in Parliament, which is why he has mentioned it," Mr. Rajak told reporters in Patna.

He argued that elected representatives from Dalit communities should be allowed adequate floor time not only during debates on Bills but also on other issues concerning their constituencies.

'Give adequate time'

"Certainly, not just on Bills but on other issues as well, Dalit representatives should be given time to speak so that the issues for which the Poona Pact was reached, and the opposition to which had taken place, do not arise again. Dalits, ordinary members of the Dalit community and their representatives, should not feel that they are inferior or different from others," he said.



Shyam Rajak

The remarks come after Mr. Manjhi, in a letter dated September 16 to the Lok Sabha Speaker, referred to concerns raised during an NDA MPs' group meeting held at his residence on August 5.

He said BJP MP Gajendra Singh Patel, who represents the reserved tribal constituency of Khargone in Madhya Pradesh, had pointed out that SC and ST MPs were not being given adequate time to participate in debates on important Bills.

Mr. Manjhi urged the Speaker to take steps to address the issue and ensure that MPs from Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe communities receive sufficient opportunities to contribute to parliamentary proceedings. Speaking to reporters from Gaya, Mr. Manjhi said that perhaps he should have addressed his letter to Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju, since allotting time for debates is his prerogative.

He further explained that each minister in the government chairs groups of 14-15 NDA MPs who meet regularly.

J&K LoP meets Amit Shah, discusses matters related to Assembly session

The Hindu Bureau
SRINAGAR

Sunil Sharma, BJP MLA and the Leader of Opposition in the Jammu and Kashmir Assembly, met Union Home Minister Amit Shah in New Delhi on Saturday, a day after J&K Chief Minister Omar Abdullah introduced a resolution on the restoration of Statehood in the Union Territory's legislature.

A BJP spokesman said Mr. Sharma apprised the Union Home Minister of matters "related to the prevailing security situation, law and order, development initiatives, public concerns, and matters re-

lated to the ongoing session of the J&K Legislative Assembly".

"Mr. Sharma highlighted the key concerns being raised by the people of J&K and discussed matters requiring continued attention, coordination, and support from the Union government," the BJP spokesman said.

Mr. Shah reiterated the Union government's commitment to peace, development, and prosperity in J&K and assured Mr. Sharma of continued support and cooperation in addressing matters concerning the people of the Union Territory, the spokesman said. Centre already com-



Sunil Sharma

mitted to Statehood'

The meeting between Mr. Shah and Mr. Sharma assumed significance in the wake of the resolution brought in by Mr. Abdullah on the restoration of Statehood to J&K. The resolution also referred to the 2000 report on greater au-

tonomy and the 2024 resolution on special status, calling upon the Centre to meet the demands of the people of J&K.

National Conference spokesman Imran Nabi Dar clarified the intention of the resolution. "People of Jammu will not support the stand of the BJP on Statehood. Only way to bring relief to the people of J&K is granting Statehood. Eight BJP MLAs supported the 2000 autonomy resolution. How is it anti-national now? Mr. Abdullah made it clear that the current resolution is about Statehood, a commitment made by the Centre," said Mr. Dar.

Recruitment exam case: Harish Rawat appears before ED

Press Trust of India
DEHRADUN

Former Uttarakhand Chief Minister and senior Congress leader Harish Rawat arrived at the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) Dehradun office on Saturday for questioning in a 2016 case involving alleged irregularities in a recruitment exam.

Mr. Rawat wore a photograph of his mother around his neck as he entered the office.

The case pertains to alleged irregularities in the 2016 Village Panchayat Development Officer recruitment examination con-

ducted by the Uttarakhand Subordinate Services Selection Commission.

In connection with the matter, the ED conducted searches at several locations in Dehradun on September 10, including the residence of Chandan Singh Jeena, Mr. Rawat's current personal assistant, who also served as his Officer on Special Duty during his tenure as Chief Minister.

On September 12, Mr. Rawat announced his decision to step down from all party posts after the ED recovered cash and jewellery from his personal assistant's house.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
CMG, SDSC - SHAR SRIHARIKOTA - 524124

Brief E- TENDER NOTICE: CORRIGENDUM-III (SALE EXTENSION)

e-Tender Notice No.CMG/C/CON/268716 Dtd 06-08-2026
Corrigendum Dt:25-09-2026

Refer above Tender No. for "Planning, Design, Construction, Commissioning of Crew Isolation and GAGANYATRI NIVAS facility at SDSC SHAR Sriharikota, Tirupati District of Andhra Pradesh (Civil, PH, Road, Site development, Swimming pool, Landscape, Electrical, AC, and allied works in EPC MODE- II). (Est. cost ₹2602 Lakhs);

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PROFILES

Dissent in the Commission

Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi

The two Election Commissioners, both appointed by the government under the new 2023 law, have raised questions about changes to electoral rolls, centralised control and the Election Commission's decision-making process

Sreeparna Chakrabarty

When notices began to be issued after the publication of the draft list during the Delhi SIR [special intensive revision], one of the names was that of Election Commissioner (EC) Sukhbir Singh Sandhu. What was considered ironical on that day and time soon became a moment of reckoning for the poll body as reports emerged that Dr. Sandhu, along with his fellow Election Commissioner Vivek Joshi, had flagged many anomalies in the ongoing SIR process across the country over the last 10 months.

Though rumours of a rift within the Election Commission had been doing the rounds for some months, what came as a surprise were the formal dissent notes written by the two ECs, including one to the Cabinet Secretary, as both had been virtually handpicked by the government under the new 2023 Law for Appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners.

The Opposition Congress party had given written objections during the appointment of both in the selection committee meetings. When Dr. Sandhu was appointed along with CEC Gyanesh Kumar on March 14, 2024, following the retirement of EC Anup Chandra Pandey and the abrupt resignation of EC Arun Goel, Congress leader Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury had given a formal dissent note in the selection committee. Later, when Mr. Joshi was appointed on February 17, 2025 after Gyanesh Kumar was elevated to CEC, Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi raised objection in the committee meeting.

Both the Election Commissioners had reportedly flagged several key issues, including the centralisation of the Electoral Rolls. In May this year, Mr. Joshi proposed an audit to certify that “no one except the concerned statutory authorities has any credentials to make any change in the (voter) database”. In August, Dr. Sandhu recorded that State-level election officials were reporting that

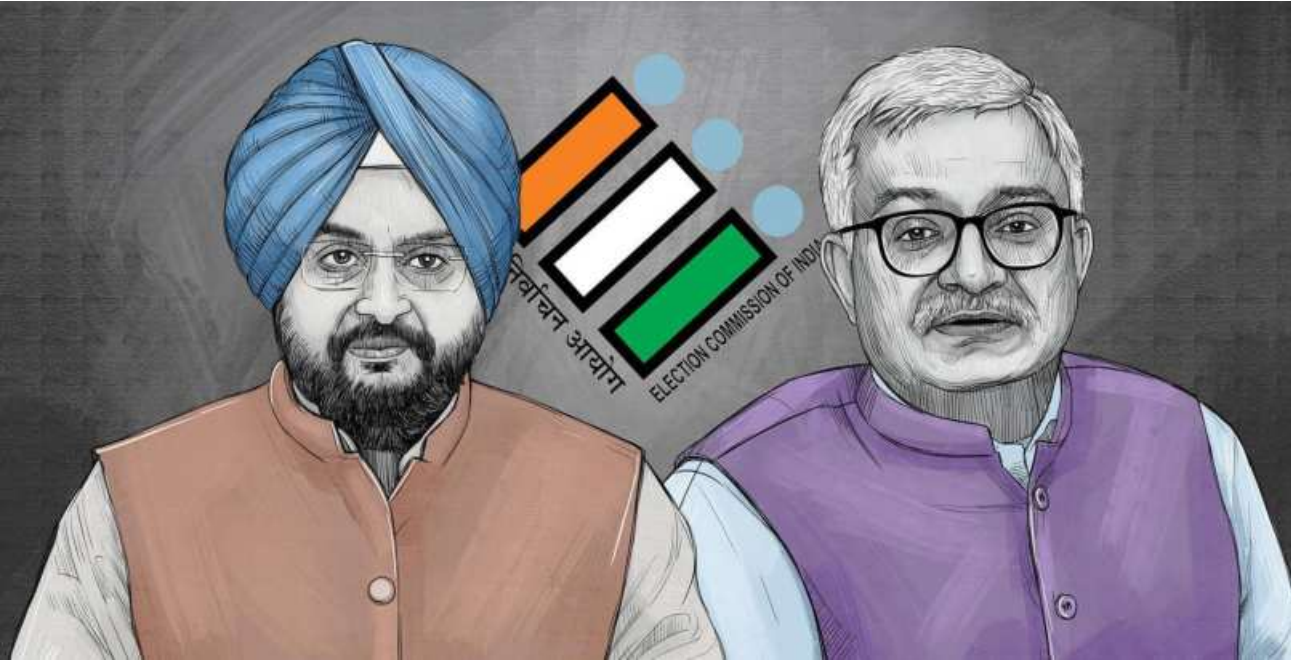


ILLUSTRATION: R. RAJESH

they do not have “proper and complete access” to the ERONet portal – the digital system through which the electoral rolls are maintained. He further flagged that Election Commission Director General of IT “does not have any legal authority to restrict proper and complete access and freedom to operate as given by law to the statutory authorities”.

‘Unauthorised and illegal’

The two ECs also said that Form 6 – which new voters must fill to register– was altered to ask if the applicant or their parents/grandparents “exist” in the electoral roll of the last SIR. They warned as early as May that such a statutory form cannot be changed without amending the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, and Dr. Sandhu called the change “unauthorised and illegal” in August, demanding its immediate removal. He also questioned who had authorised the Commission in West Bengal to file appeals against voters whom judicial tribunals had already included in the rolls – with 38 lakh appeals pending.

They also flagged the Goa case in which 97 voters, found eligible by local Electoral Registration Officers (EROs)

after a Supreme Court-mandated hearing, were left off the final roll because the centrally controlled software had no mechanism to record the EROs’ decisions. The Chief Electoral Officer’s (CEO) office had written eight times seeking a rollback option.

However, some experts, including former Election Commissioners, have questioned why the two did not seek a meeting of the full Commission and attempt to resolve these issues through a majority vote.

As per provisions of the Election Commission (Conditions of Service of Election Commissioners and Transaction of Business) Act, 1991, which has been carried forward to the 2023 Act, all decisions by the Election Commission have to be unanimous, where possible. But if the CEC and the other Election Commissioners genuinely differ in opinion on a matter, it is to be decided according to the opinion of the majority with each Commissioner (including the CEC) carrying equal weight in the vote. The vote of the CEC does not have any special veto. Dr. Sandhu is a retired 1988-batch IAS officer of the Uttarakhand cadre. Born in 1963, he

holds an MBBS from Government Medical College, Amritsar, a master’s degree in history from Guru Nanak Dev University, and a law degree. He was Chief Secretary, Government of Uttarakhand, from July 2021 to January 2024, where he is credited with having overseen the ideation for implementing the Uniform Civil Code.

He was also Chairman of the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI), Additional Secretary, Department of Higher Education, Ministry of Human Resource Development and Commissioner, Ludhiana Municipal Corporation – for which he was awarded the President’s Medal. He is also an expert on urban reforms and has authored many papers on municipal management. Dr. Sandhu also briefly served as Secretary, Lokpal of India, from February 5 to March 14, 2024, just before he was appointed as an Election Commissioner.

Vivek Joshi was born on May 21, 1966, in Uttar Pradesh. A 1989-batch IAS officer of the Haryana cadre, he’s a mechanical engineer from IIT-Roorkee. He holds a master’s degree in International Business from IIFT, New Delhi, and an MA and PhD in

International Economics from the Graduate Institute, Geneva.

He has served as a Financial Services Secretary and Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India. Earlier, he was member secretary of the Fifth State Finance Commission of Haryana.

Unexpected appointment

When he was appointed EC at 58, he was among the younger members appointed to the poll panel and had taken voluntary retirement before joining the Election Commission, which was considered somewhat unusual.

He himself had called the appointment “unexpected” and noted it was meaningful to him personally as it brought him back to his home cadre (Haryana) briefly before moving to the central body. Mr. Joshi also has family members in the bureaucracy. His brother, Vineet Joshi, a 1992-batch IAS officer, serves as Secretary, Higher Education.

His term runs until February 2031.

Given the seniority order among current commissioners, if Mr. Kumar demits office in January 2029 after retiring, then Mr. Joshi would be the senior-most EC and could succeed him as Dr. Sandhu retires in July 2028. However, if Mr. Kumar has to go before July 2028, Dr. Sandhu becomes the senior-most as he was appointed before Mr. Joshi.

Most importantly, the 2023 Act for appointment of ECs and CEC doesn’t guarantee automatic succession by seniority. Instead, the Act provides a statutory framework for the appointment, tenure, and service conditions of the CEC and ECs, replacing the earlier system governed largely by convention.

There is no clause in the Act that says the senior-most EC automatically becomes CEC when a vacancy arises. Every appointment – including to the post of CEC – goes through this same fresh appointment process unlike the earlier tradition of the next senior-most Election Commissioner being the successor to the incumbent CEC.

THE GIST

▼ In May this year, Joshi proposed an audit to certify that “no one except the concerned statutory authorities has any credentials to make any change in the (voter) database”

▼ In August, Dr. Sandhu recorded that State-level election officials were reporting that they do not have “proper and complete access” to the ERONet portal – the digital system through which the electoral rolls are maintained

▼ However, some experts, including former Election Commissioners, have questioned why the two did not seek a meeting of the full Commission and attempt to resolve these issues through a majority vote

The Arctic race

U.S.-Greenland deal

Washington will establish two new military bases in the world’s largest island as it seeks to expand its presence in the Arctic region and check Russian and Chinese influence

Stanly Johny

“Essentially, it’s a large real estate deal. A lot of things can be done,” U.S. President Donald Trump said in August 2019, during his first term, when asked whether the U.S. would be interested in acquiring Greenland. After he returned to office in January 2025, Mr. Trump repeated his threat. “We need Greenland for national security purposes,” he said in January 2025. You look outside. You have Chinese ships all over the place. You have Russian ships all over the place. We’re not letting that happen.”

Greenland, a Danish territory located between the Arctic Ocean and the North Atlantic Ocean, was home for at least 30 American military bases and installations during the Second World War. The island’s strategic profile grew in recent years after Russia and China stepped up their activities in the Arctic region, partly because of ice melting which opened up previously unpassable regions. Mr. Trump’s threats to take over the island incensed Denmark, a founding member of NATO, and America’s other European allies. The crisis further strained the transatlantic ties. But on September 22, on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly, the leaders of the U.S., Denmark and Greenland



AP

signed a new security agreement, which, according to Mr. Trump, would allow the U.S. “to do what is necessary in Greenland”.

The 1951 U.S.-Denmark security agreement provides Washington broad rights to build military bases in the ice-covered island. Most American bases on the island were shut down over the years, particularly after the Cold War. Now the U.S. stations some 150 troops at its Pituffik Space Base in Greenland. U.S. officials wanted to increase this military presence which they argued was important to monitor and defend the northern approaches of North America and North Atlantic at a time when the race to control the Arctic is heating up. Russia has extensive Arctic territory and military infrastructure. Greenland also possesses significant mineral resources, including rare earths, a segment which is currently dominated by China. U.S. officials have raised concerns about potential Chinese invest-

ments in Greenland. So Denmark, which has already blocked Chinese investments in Greenland, had said it would allow Washington to expand its military presence on the island, but insisted that Danish sovereignty and Greenland’s self-governing rights be respected. The latest security agreement with the U.S. sought to address both America’s demands and Danish concerns.

Terms of the deal

Denmark, which has already blocked Chinese investments in Greenland, had said it would allow Washington to expand its military presence on the island, but insisted that Danish sovereignty and Greenland’s self-governing rights be respected. The latest security agreement with the U.S. sought to address both America’s demands and Danish concerns.

According to the agreement, even if Greenland, which has a population of around 50,000, becomes independent, it would respect the deal with the U.S. and stay within NATO. In other words, this deal pro-

vides the U.S. indefinite access to the island’s military facilities. The deal, which reaffirms “the sovereignty and territorial integrity of the Kingdom of Denmark” and recognises the “self determination of the people of Greenland”, also stipulates that no hostile power (non-NATO countries) can establish military facilities on the island or invest in its sensitive areas (mainly rare earths). The U.S. will be allowed to establish additional defence facilities in Narsarsuaq in the south, where it had an airfield during the Second World War, and in Mestersvig in the east. The Mestersvig facility would allow the U.S. to monitor the waters between the island and the Scandinavian region. Greenland would also be part of the U.S. Golden Dome anti-missile shield, and Danish authorities have pledged to work together with Washington to counter espionage in Greenland, a reference to alleged Chinese activities in the region.

On paper, Greenland would remain a self-governing territory of Denmark. But in practice, the U.S. would have indefinite rights to build military facilities on the island and a say in its economic policies and resource extraction. Mr. Trump may not have secured ownership of the world’s largest island, but he appears to have secured almost everything else.

The ‘party of power’

United Russia

The political party affiliated to President Vladimir Putin is the big bear that continues to win almost all elections in the country

G.R. Rajeev

Often during his international engagements, the one question that infuriates Russian President Vladimir Putin the most is if Russia is a “managed democracy”. He has been vehement in saying it’s not. “The road to democracy must be adapted to the realities of Russian life, traditions, and history,” Mr. Putin said in February 2005 at a press conference.

But, despite his protestations, democracy in Russia is under intense scrutiny. Mr. Putin’s party, United Russia, is the big bear that wins almost all elections in Russia. In the just-concluded parliamentary elections, United Russia got 349 out of the 450 seats in the Duma, polling 58% of the vote for the 225 seats apportioned by parties and winning 209 single-seat races that fill the other half of the lower chamber of Parliament. The vote, western observers said, was flawed. In August, Russia’s Supreme Court barred Yabloko, the only party running on an anti-war platform, from appearing on the ballot, as polls showed it gaining in popularity and possibly poised to win enough votes to enter Parliament.

The 2024 Presidential election was no different. The result of Russia’s March 15-17 election was



AP

known to everyone even before the first ballot was cast, *The Hindu* noted in its editorial, as Mr. Putin won nearly 88% of the vote. The country saw a record turnout of 77.44% and the results showed that Russia “is united” under the long-time leader, Ella Pamylova, Election Commission chief, said. Only Kremlin-tolerated candidates, meaning those who could not challenge Mr. Putin and United Russia, were allowed to contest.

Kremlin party

United Russia, called variously as the “party of power” or for its nebulous ideology, the “big-tent” party, is the Kremlin party, and it’s debatable if the party wants to keep Mr. Putin in power or if it’s the other way. In December 2001, Mr. Putin’s Unity party and Fatherland-All Russia, a leading Opposition group, merged to form an entity which became United Russia in 2003.

As Acting President after Boris Yeltsin resigned six months before the end

of his term on January 1, 2000 and handed over power to him, Mr. Putin, who was Prime Minister before being elevated, went on to consolidate his grip on the state. “Russian democracy now speaks with but one voice. Just 18 months ago, leaders of five ideological factions were waging a pitched public battle to succeed Mr. Yeltsin. Now there is only Mr. Putin, a man of no classifiable ideology beyond building a strong Russia, his rule endorsed by three of every four Russians, according to polls,” the *New York Times* reported on January 21, 2001, after Mr. Putin won the presidency in an election. A few days later, Parliament introduced a Bill that would drastically reduce the number of registered parties from 57 to just six.

The news agency Tass, owned by the Russian government, says United Russia “promotes centrist and conservative ideas, stands for strengthening the country’s sovereignty, increasing its defence capa-

bilities, advancing the patriotic education of young people, enhancing investment, introducing innovative technologies, developing democracy and civil society institutions”. In the 2017 article, Tass reported that the party had two million members.

Under Mr. Putin and United Russia, statism, rooted in Orthodox Christian conservative values, replaced the state-sanctioned communism of the Soviet years, *The Hindu* editorial noted. They mastered a complex model of a tightly held state with regular elections and little dissent. Party leaders variously call it centrist and conservative. Researchers term it Russian integralism. Opposition leaders call United Russia a “party of crooks and thieves”, a phrase popularised by Alexei Navalny, an anti-corruption activist who died in prison.

Gleb Pavlovsky, Putin adviser-turned-critic, is considered the chief architect of the “managed democracy” system in Russia. Vladislav Surkov, former Putin aide called the “grey cardinal” of Kremlin, rebranded it as “sovereign democracy”. The Economist described him as the architect of “a system of make-believe”, involving imitation political parties, stage-managed media, and orchestrated social movements. Mr. Putin, however, is in denial in public.

INCREDIBLE INAMDAR

‘Didn’t even have food at home, now I have two Asiad medals’



REUTERS

It still feels like a dream to me. I often think about how someone who didn’t even have food at home now holds two international (Asiad) medals. I want young, underprivileged players to dream big and aim to achieve even more than I have — Aslam Inamdar, right in pic, after winning his second successive Asian Games gold.

PERFECT RECORD

Indian men’s hockey team edges Japan, books semifinal berth



AHF

Defending champion India advanced to the semifinals of the Asian Games men’s hockey competition after defeating Japan 2-0 in a Pool A contest in Kakamigahaa on Saturday. Abhishek scored a field goal in the 15th minute while skipper Harmanpreet Singh converted a penalty corner in the 40th. This was India’s fourth straight win.

REWARDED

‘Shifting to marathon would have been a waste of time without this’



REUTERS

Sawan Barwal said that shifting to marathon earlier this year would have been a “waste of time” had he not won a medal at the Asian Games in Nagoya. “This medal is very precious. If I had not won this medal, it would have been meaningless and a waste of time. This is a big achievement for me,” Sawan said after his silver show.

TALKING TOUGH

There will be an enquiry: AFI on Jyothi and Praveen’s pull outs



FILE PHOTO: RITU RAJ KONWAR

The AFI has taken a dim view of the absence of hurdler Jyothi Varraji and triple jumper Praveen Chithravel at the Asian Games on Saturday. “There will be an enquiry. We will look into all the details and then take whatever action might be needed,” AFI spokesperson and former president Adille Sumariwalla told *The Hindu*.

Indian kabaddi teams dominate with double gold

Both defeat perennial rival Iran to retain titles; the men’s side fights back from a one-point deficit at half-time while the women’s outfit keeps its cool in the final phase to come up trumps

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Three years ago, the Indian men’s kabaddi team had won an ill-tempered, farcical and close Asian Games final against perennial rival Iran that went into the history books as a lesson on how not to conduct a competition.

On Saturday, the teams played out yet another title clash but things were far more subdued with India winning 40-34 for its ninth gold in 10 editions and reiterating its absolute chokehold on the sport.

Reliable medal hope

With the women retaining their medal from Hangzhou with a 37-34 victory — also against Iran — the gol-



This is who we are! The men’s and women’s kabaddi teams doubled India’s gold tally by living up to the billing on Saturday. R.V. MOORTHY & ANI

den double ensured kabaddi remains India’s most reliable medal hope at the Games.

An India-Iran encounter in the men’s final was expected, nay assumed from the moment the draw had been made. The two po-

werhouses are miles ahead of the rest and any challenge to India’s superiority could only come from the Iranians. The title decider lived up to its billing.

India and Iran traded points early on and were content staying level with-

out getting too adventurous in both attack and defence. Arjun Deshwal and Devank Dalal led India’s raids while captain Sunil Kumar, along with Jaideep and Sumit, held firm in defence.

Amirmohammad Zafar



Danesh completed an all-out and the contest remained in balance with Iran taking a one-point lead into half-time. Post break, India regrouped: a super tackle and a successful raid by Aslam Inamdar helped India level the

score at 20-20.

Iran skipper Fazel Atrachali and Omid Khojasteh Mohammadshah mounted a brief recovery while Ali Samadi tried to earn raiding points. But the turning point came when Arjun set up an all-out that opened

up a five-point cushion for India with 10 minutes remaining.

Leading 39-32 with under 20 seconds left on the clock, India sealed gold in emphatic fashion.

Earlier, the India women’s team had to fight off

Medals table

	Country	G	S	B	T
1	China	107	41	28	176
2	Japan	31	49	49	129
3	South Korea	16	21	36	73
4	Uzbekistan	8	17	9	34
5	Kazakhstan	8	8	19	35
10	India	4	12	14	30

a stiff challenge from the 2018 champion for a narrow three-point win. It dominated the first half, at the end of which it led 22-16.

But Iran went on the offensive in the second period, reducing the margin. Pooja and Sanju Devi worked tirelessly, one point at a time, in every raid, as India stayed ahead before retaining the title.

Sawan bags marathon silver; Tajinderpal finishes second; Prachi pulls off a surprise



One to cherish: Sawan bettered his own National record while Prachi managed a podium finish. AP & PTI



Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

A day that began with the longest competitive distance in athletics producing one of the most precious medals for India ended with questions around selections and accountability of absentee athletes that overshadowed the impressive performances of those who did turn up to do their best.

Saturday morning at the Asian Games here saw Sawan Barwal, a man who started running marathons only a year ago, break not only his own National record by an incredible 21 seconds (2:11:37s) but also win India’s first Games silver in the event in 44 years. He had already shattered one of the longest standing records in Indian athletics, Shivan Singh’s 1978 timing of 2:12:00, by running 2:11:58 in April.

More importantly, this is only the fourth Indian me-



Tajinderpal. PTI

dal in Asiad marathon and the first outside the country. For a while, it looked like the 28-year-old could go all the way before Japan’s Ichitaka Yamashita (2:10:49) edged ahead in the home stretch.

In the evening, Tajinderpal Singh Toor failed to complete his hat-trick of Asian Games gold, settling for silver at the Paloma Mizuho athletics stadium in incessant rain and cold weather. Tajinderpal managed a best throw of

20.64m on his fifth attempt but could not get past Iran Mohammadreza Tayebise, who set a new Games record of 20.81m, for the top spot.

Prachi Choudhary was a surprise bronze medallist in women’s 400m (53.21s), but the rest disappointed.

Karthik Unnikrishnan was sixth in triple jump (16.02m) while Kiran Pahal was fifth in 400m (53.41s). Vishal T.K. was placed fifth among the men’s 400m (45.48s) and Parul Chaudhary, despite a personal best of 4:09.46, could only manage fourth in women’s 1500m.

Tejaswin Shankar, meanwhile, was leading the decathlon charts with 4,338 points after five events.

But eyebrows were raised when Jyothi Varraji, silver medallist in 100m hurdles last time around, and National record holder triple jumper Praveen Chithravel both pulled out of the competition.

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Saturday:

Athletics: Men: Marathon final: Sawan (silver), Kartik (17th); Shot put final: Tajinderpal (silver), Karanveer (10th); 400m final: Vishal (fifth); Triple jump final: Karthik (sixth); 200m semifinals: Animesh (second in heat 3), qualified for the final; 1500m: Yonus (third in heat 1) and Gulveer (third in heat 2), both qualified for the final. Women: 400m final: Prachi (bronze), Kiran (fifth); 1500m final: Parul (fourth), Pooja (sixth); 200m: Harita (second in heat 2) and Unnathi (third in heat 3), both qualified for the final; 100m hurdles: Nandhini (fourth in heat 2), qualified for the final.

Badminton: Men: Third round: Ayush lost to Chou (Tpe) 1-2; Second round: Lakshya lost to Yew (Sgp) 1-2; Women: Third round: P.V. Sindhu bt Miyazaki (Jpn) 2-0; Unnati bt Wardani (Ina) 2-0; Doubles: Second round: Treasa & Gayatri bt Mayu & Yuki (Jpn) 2-0.

Boxing: Round-of-16: Men’s 55kg: Jadumani lost to Paalam (Pir); Men’s 90kg: Kapil bt Estaki (Iri); Women’s 60kg: Priya bt Yeonji (Kor).

Hockey: Men (Pool A): bt Japan 2-0.

Kabaddi: Finals: Women: bt Iran 37-34; Men: bt Iran 40-34.

Shooting: 50m rifle 3P women individual final: Tilottama (fourth), Vidarsa (fifth); Team final: Silver (Tilottama, Ashi, Vidarsa).

Squash: Semifinals: Men: Abhay bt Irfan (Pak) 3-0; Women: Anahat bt Watanabe (Jpn) 3-2; Mixed doubles: Velavan & Joshna lost to Yi & Hong (Hkg) 1-2, bagged bronze.

Table tennis: Round 3: Women: Yashawini lost to Harimoto (Jpn) 1-4; Men: Manush lost to Lin (Chn) 0-4.



Sindhu. GETTY IMAGES



Productive day: Tilottama, Vidarsa and Ashi totalled 1,763 to take the second spot. PTI

India bags silver in women’s 50m rifle 3P

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

The Indian trio of Tilottama Sen, Vidarsa Vinod and Ashi Chouksey won the silver in women’s 50m rifle 3P team event at the Asian Games here on Saturday.

Tilottama finished fourth in the individual final while Vidarsa was fifth. The latter was also part of the 10m air rifle team which won a silver to open India’s account in this edition.

The Indian team aggregated 1,763 to finish second on the podium. China claimed the gold medal with a Games record total of 1,773.

Kazakhstan ended with

the bronze (1,754). In the individual final, Tilottama was crestfallen after a 9.4 at a crucial stage of the contest put paid to her hopes of finishing on the podium one more time.

The 18-year-old, who was leading after the first 25 shots in the final and was placed third after 30 shots, ended the competition with 337.3 followed by Vidarsa (327.4).

New high

China’s Jiayu Han won the gold medal with an Asian record of 359 and her compatriot Liyuan Zhang (358.8) took home the silver. South Korea’s Jieun Kim (348.4) bagged the bronze medal.

Tough for Anahat, easy for Abhay; Joshna-Velavan lose

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Anahat Singh has made it a habit of creating history and the reigning junior World champion added another to her list on Saturday, becoming the first Indian woman to make the Asian Games squash final.

On the men’s side, Abhay Singh reached the title decider, both Indians setting up title clashes with the reigning champions.

Anahat’s 3-2 (9-11, 11-13, 12-10, 11-6, 11-3) win, coming in 51 minutes after being 0-2 down against World No. 6 and local favourite Satomi Watanabe, was incredible as much for her fightback as her composure — the only time she had any reaction was after winning the third game, letting out a triumphant scream. The 18-year-old Anahat looked tentative starting out, trying to play cautiously, and was content with not letting her opponent run away with easy points.

It was a contrast to the men’s semifinal that followed, Abhay winning 3-0



Joshna and Velavan... a bronze medal. R.V. MOORTHY

(11-3, 12-10, 11-6) against Pakistan’s Mohd. Irfan with only a brief struggle towards the end.

Earlier, Joshna Chinappa and Velavan Senthilkumar were practically robbed of a place in the mixed doubles final and had to finish with a bronze.

Unfortunate

The duo fought back from a game down and looked like they had won their semifinal against Lee Ka Yi and Tang Ming Hong of Hong Kong before the winning point in the final game was overturned.

They eventually lost 10-11, 11-2, 10-11.

INDIANS IN ACTION

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Sunday (all times IST):

Athletics: Women’s marathon race walk final (Manju, Priyanka), 4 a.m.; Men’s decathlon (Tejaswin, Thowfeeq), 7.30 a.m. onwards; Men’s 400m hurdles heats (Santhosh, Yashas), 8.35 a.m.; Women’s 400m hurdles heats (Vithya, Anu), 9.05 a.m.; Men’s long jump qualification (David, Sreeshankar), 9.10 a.m.; Women’s long jump final (Ancy, Shaili), 3.25 p.m.; Men’s 200m

final (Animesh), 4.05 p.m.; Men’s high jump final (Sarvesh, Aadarsh), 4.15 p.m.; Women’s 100m hurdles final (Nandhini), 4.50 p.m.; Men’s 800m heats (Afsal, Krishan), 5 p.m.; Women’s 3000m steeplechase final (Parul, Ankita), 5.50 p.m.; Women’s 4x100m relay heats, 6.15 p.m.; Women’s 4x400m relay heats, 7 p.m.

Badminton: Mixed doubles (quarterfinals): Dhruv & Tanisha vs. Zhe & Dongping (Chn), 6.10 a.m.

Boxing: Quarterfinals: Men’s 80kg: Ankush vs. Salimov (Tjk), 9.45 a.m.; Women’s 65kg: Parveen vs. Khamidova (Uzb), 2 p.m.; Men’s 60kg: Sachin vs. Kitamoto (Jpn), 2.45 p.m.; Men’s +90kg: Narendra vs. Saengtep (Tha), 3.45 p.m.

Hockey: Women (Pool B): vs. Singapore, 3.30 p.m.

Shooting: 25m pistol women individual qualification and team final (Precision) — Manu, Esha, Rahi, 6.10 a.m.; Trap men individual qualification and team

final (day 1) — Ahvar, Kynan, Shaphat, 6.30 a.m.

Trap women individual qualification and team final (day 1) — Maneesha, Aashima, Neeru, 6.30 a.m.

Squash: Finals: Men: Abhay vs Eain (Mas), 12.30 p.m.; Women: Anahat vs. Sivasangari (Mas), 1.30 p.m.

Volleyball: Men (Pool C): vs. Vietnam, 12.30 p.m.

Weightlifting: Women’s 69kg final (Harjinder), 10 a.m.

Men in Blue begin ODI World Cup countdown

The three-match series against the Windies promises plenty of action; the visiting side will be desperate for a good show in a country where it hasn't won a bilateral series since 2002

WEST INDIES IN INDIA

P.K. Ajith Kumar
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

They were gone. All those thousands of tickets. Gone in a matter of hours.

A young cricket fan, who lives near the Greenfield Stadium, still blames himself for not logging in a bit earlier on the day ticket sales opened. He tried the black market, too, though it would have cost him three times the actual price, but no ticket was available.

So much for all those talks about the meaninglessness of bilateral ODI series. The 50-over format has its own charms. Granted, it is no Test match. Nothing is. But it offers an awful lot more than T20 cricket.

The three-match ODI series between India and the West Indies, which begins here on Sunday, indeed promises plenty.

With the World Cup just a year away, this is the beginning of the road map for India definitely, though the same cannot be said about the visiting team, which, first has to qualify for the game's showpiece (and this was the team that won the first two editions and lost to India in the final of the third).

Looking ahead – and preparing for – the World Cup is fine. But, if you are



Gearing up: West Indies batter Carty trains hard on match eve. NIRMAL HARINDRAN

someone who believes that art is for art's sake, this is one series you wouldn't want to miss: you get to watch two of the modern masters, Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma.

This is, of course, the only format they play for India. And they are not going to be around forever. Kohli is 37. Rohit is 39. You hardly would have thought of that when you watched them play in England just a couple of months ago.

This series could also see both reaching more milestones: Kohli needs only 59 more to become the second man to score 15,000 ODI runs after Sa-

chin Tendulkar, while Rohit requires 105 to touch 12,000.

The other top-order batter, skipper Shubman Gill, has been in sublime form, and is the world's No. 1 in the format.

He doesn't have at his disposal the best possible XI because of the ongoing Asian Games and injury concerns, but that opens opportunities for players like Rituraj Gaikwad, Aaquib Nabi and Naman Dhir.

The West Indians will be desperate for a good show in a country where they haven't won an ODI series since 2002.

Shai Hope and his men

may not find it easy against the class, experience and skills of India.

The teams (from): India: Shubman Gill (Capt.), Rohit Sharma, Virat Kohli, K.L. Rahul (wk), Rituraj Gaikwad, Yashasvi Jaiswal, Ravindra Jadeja, Dhruv Jurel, Nitish Kumar, Kuldeep Yadav, Mohammed Siraj, Prasidh Krishna, Gurnoor Brar, Aaquib Nabi and Naman Dhir.

West Indies: Shai Hope (Capt.), John Campbell, Keacy Carty, Sherfane Rutherford, Justin Greaves, Amir Jangoo, Matthew Forde, Roston Chase, Gudakesh Motie, Alzarri Joseph, Jayden Seales, Shamar Joseph, Jewel Andrew, Vitel Lawes and Keemo Paul.

Match starts at 2 p.m.

It is not a case of Jaiswal being treated unfairly, says Kotak

P.K. Ajith Kumar
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

If a batter of Yashasvi Jaiswal's talent cannot find a place in the Indian ODI team, that says a lot about the problem of plenty. Indian batting coach Sitan-shu Kotak on Saturday indicated that the left-handed opener might have to wait for his opportunity.

"There is so much competition for places in the team and so many players are performing," Kotak said. "Jaiswal is one of the best, and whenever he gets an opportunity, he performs. But sometimes, you see, say there are three very good wicketkeepers in a



Not hanging around: Kohli says next year's ODI World Cup will be his last appearance at the global level. NIRMAL HARINDRAN

team and only one will play. It is not a case of Jaiswal being treated unfairly. It is part of the game.

"He should keep working hard and wait for his

opportunity."

Kotak feels Ravindra Jadeja is in the scheme of things for next year's World Cup. "I am not part of the selection committee,

so I don't know what they are thinking. I think whoever is playing for India stands chances. Jadeja is an outstanding all-rounder, we all know. And to me, he is still one of the world's best fielders.

"He bowls, he bats and he has the experience. I believe experience is something you cannot beat. So we see Rohit, we see Virat, and Jadeja is also like that. All that brings a lot to the team. It is all about sharing experiences... I have seen all the experienced players, even Gautam (Gambhir), doing that. When they see that some player is going in a situation, they always talk to them."

Indian women hold China; men romp to a win

CHESS OLYMPIAD

Sports Bureau

For the second time inside three days, B. Savitha Shri proved India's saviour. The 19-year-old girl from Chennai ensured India at least got a match point in the penultimate round of the Chess Olympiad at Samarkand on Saturday.

India was trailing 1-2 against the sole leader China, but Savitha's win on the fourth board over Zhai Mo helped her team draw 2-2, keeping alive the hopes of a medal going into Sunday's final round. Koneru Humpy and Divya Deshmukh had drawn their games, and Vantika Agrawal lost, and that meant



Turning it around: Nihal returned to winning ways. FIDE

Savitha was in a must-win situation.

This was her eighth win from nine games; she has drawn one and lost none. Thanks in no small measure to the debutant's superb show, India is joint se-

cond in the women's event with 16 points.

In the open section, India is in sole second position with 17 points, one behind leader Uzbekistan.

The Indian men posted a 3.5-0.5 win against the

host's second team, Uzbekistan (2).

Important results (10th round): Open: India bt Uzbekistan (2) 3.5-0.5 (R. Praggnanandhaa bt Jakhongir Vakhidov; Arjun Erigaisi drew with Abdimalik Abdusalimov; Nihal Sarin bt Mukhammadzokhid Suyarov; D. Gukesh bt Ortik Nigmatov). Uzbekistan bt Armenia 3.5-0.5; Ukraine bt China 3-1; Germany bt France 3-1; USA bt Greece 3-1; Netherlands bt Romania 2.5-1.5; Azerbaijan bt Bulgaria 2.5-1.5; Turkey bt Argentina 3.5-0.5; Serbia bt Lithuania 2.5-1.5.

Women: India drew with China 2-2 (Koneru Humpy drew with Zhu Jiner; Divya Deshmukh drew with Song Yuxin; Vantika Agrawal lost to Lu Miaoyi; B. Savitha Shri bt Zhai Mo). Uzbekistan bt Peru 3.5-0.5; Poland bt Mongolia 3-1; Armenia drew with Greece 2-2; Vietnam bt Indonesia 2.5-1.5; Georgia bt England 2.5-1.5; USA bt Israel 4-0.



Bhuvan.

Saishiva and Bhuvan hog the limelight

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Teenagers Saishiva Sankaran of Pune and Visakhapatnam's Bhuvan Bonu won the MRF Formula 2000 and Formula 1600 races in the second round of the MRF Indian National Racing Challenge 4W-2026 which commenced at the Madras International Circuit here on Saturday.

The results: Provisional: MRF F2000 (Race-1, 8 laps): 1. Saishiva Sankaran (12:52.987); 2. Ishaan Madesh (12:53.390); 3. Krishay Gutte (13:02.171). **MRF F1600 (Race-1, 8 laps):** 1. Bhuvan Bonu (14:02.774); 2. Tanmay Kothari (14:05.299); 3. S. Gyan (14:07.075). **Formula LGB 1300 (Race-1, 2 laps): Open:** 1. Viswas Vijayaraj (DTS Racing) 03:54.047; 2. Liron Jaden Samuels (DTS Racing) 03:55.174; 3. T.S. Diljit (DTS Racing) 03:55.260. **Juniors (2 laps):** 1. Kaveen Diyyan Rajapaksa (Momentum Motorsports) 04:02.111; 2. Pranav Ramasamy (DTS Racing) 04:05.547; 3. Shatveer Shetty (Momentum Motorsports) 04:05.604.

LIVE TELECAST

South Africa vs Australia: Second ODI, FanCode, 1.30 p.m.

India vs West Indies: First ODI, Star Sports 1 & JioHotstar, 2 p.m.

England vs Sri Lanka: Third ODI, Sony Sports Ten 5 & LIV, 3 p.m.

Asian Games: Sony Sports Ten 5 & LIV, 5.30 a.m. (Monday).

Cricket: Asian Games (Men), Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 5.30 a.m. (Monday).

A test of patience in u-19 multi-day games

Shayan Acharya
RAJKOT

The white-ball job is done. Now comes the test of patience.

After sweeping Australia 3-0 in the Youth ODI series, India under-19 switches formats when the two-match Youth Test series begins at the Niranjan Shah Stadium here on Sunday.

Carrying confidence Home captain Yashbardhan Singh Chauhan and his deputy Lakshya Raichandani will be carrying the confidence from the one-dayers into the red-ball format.

The squad has a slightly

different look.

Aaryavir Sehwal and Anvay Dravid are not part of the multi-day group. Wicketkeeper-batters Manav Krishna and Abhipray Biswas are among the 15 while Manal Chauhan, Kushagra Ojha, Sagar Virk and Kush Patel add batting depth.

On what could be another flat deck, pacers Ayaan Akram, Pranav Ragavendra and Mohit Ulva will have to make the necessary adjustments.

Australia, on the other hand, will be looking to bounce back. The visiting team will have more time to settle in and test its skills.

BFC to face Sporting Club Delhi in ISL season opener

Press Trust of India
MUMBAI

Bengaluru FC will take on Sporting Club Delhi at home in the Indian Super League season opener on October 10, followed by FC Goa facing Chennaiyin FC in Goa on the same day.

The 13 participating clubs for the season are Bengaluru, Chennaiyin, Churchill Brothers, East Bengal, FC Goa, Inter Kashi, Kerala Blasters, Mohun Bagan Super Giant, Mumbai City, NEUFC, Odisha, Punjab and Sporting Club Delhi.

SNAPSHOTS

Hardik suffers fresh injury, set to miss New Zealand tour

NEW DELHI: All-rounder Hardik Pandya has sustained a fresh injury to his right shin, which is set to rule him out of competitive cricket for at least three weeks, including the white-ball tour of New Zealand in October-November.

"On his return from Japan, BCCI's medical panel head Dr. Dinshaw Pardiwala will assess Hardik, who has been advised rest for two weeks," said a source.

Andre to lead TN

CHENNAI: C. Andre Siddarth will lead Tamil Nadu, the defending Col. C.K. Nayudu Trophy (under-23) champion, against Rest of India in a four-day match at the MAC Stadium from Oct. 1 to 4. **The squad:** C. Andre Siddarth (Capt.), S. Mohamed Ali

(Vice-capt.), K. Abhinav, P. Kush Bardia, Kiran Karthikeyan, S.R. Athish, M. Bharath, K.T.A. Madhava Prasad, D. Deepesh, V.P. Dhiran, Om Nitin Karthikeyan, R. Pravin, Sachin Rath, Sunny Sandhu, and P. Vignesh.

Mohamed Ali at the helm

S. Mohamed Ali has been named captain of Tamil Nadu for its first two Col. C.K. Nayudu Trophy (u-23)

matches next month.

The squad: S. Mohamed Ali (Capt.), Kiran Karthikeyan (Vice-capt.), K. Abhinav, R.S. Ambrish, M. Bharath, V.P. Dhiran, R.K. Jayant, P. Khush Bardia, K.T.A. Madhava Prasad, Om Nitin Karthikeyan, R. Pravin, Sachin Rath, Sunny Sandhu, P. Vignesh.

Stand-bys/development squad: A. Badrinath, R. Bharat Srinivas, Charan Chunduru, R. Javed Mohammed, M. Mohana Prasath, Siddarth Prakash.

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA league, IV-C, Fox Trotters vs. Friends XI (Union); Chennai Port vs. Tiger (GE-B, Alstom); Sounder vs. Youth Centre (St. Bede's-A); GE India vs. MUC (Tagore); KMC vs. Galaxy (PBEL City); Bharath Petroleum vs. Ethiraj (Wahe Guru-A); V-D, Venkateswara vs. Madras Emmanuel (Jones Krish); TVS MSC vs. Eagle (St. Bede's-B); Saidapet Gymkhana vs. Gandhi (Sumangali-A). Youngsters vs. National (SMK Fomra-A); Madras Indians vs. Egmore Excelsiors (SMK Fomra-B);

Universal vs. ICI (Wahe Guru-B), 9.30 a.m. VI-A, NUC vs. Cosmopolitan Club (Gandhi Nagar); Amar vs. YMCA, Royapettah (MIT), 8 a.m. VI-B, AISC vs. Jai Hind (MIT); Chennai Corporation vs. Ashok Leyland (Engg.); IAF (Tbm.) vs. Presidency College (St. Patrick's); Eccentrics vs. Kohinoor XI (Gandhi Nagar), 1 p.m. **Motorsports:** MRF Indian National Racing Challenge 4W, second round, MIC, Sriperumbudur, 9.30 a.m.

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RAJESH KUMAR SINGH

IAS, Defence Secretary, Secretary DDR&D and Chairman DRDO (Additional Charge)

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PVSM, AVSM, SM, VSM, Chief of Defence Staff

GEN. DHIRAJ SETH

PVSM, UYSM, AVSM, Chief of the Army Staff

ADMIRAL KRISHNA SWAMINATHAN

PVSM, AVSM, VSM, Chief of the Naval Staff

AIR MARSHAL TEJPAL SINGH

AVSM, VM, Deputy Chief of the Air Staff

LIEUTENANT GENERAL DOMINIQUE TARDIF

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A CH-CHE



In dire straits: A dry tank in Gaadhepalem village near Ongole had left villagers dependent on a well within in. The village's reverse osmosis plant had also become defunct, adding to the problems. KOMMURI SRINIVAS



Welcome sight: A view of the same tank after the rain. The Irrigation Department has now filled the tank with water released from the Ramateertham Reservoir and groundwater level has also improved. KOMMURI SRINIVAS



Ecological distress: The Singarakonda tank near Addanki in Prakasam district is almost completely dried up. The remaining water is visibly stagnant and covered with algae. KOMMURI SRINIVAS



Baked earth: A school student walks across a dry pond to reach a well in Gaadhepalem village. KOMMURI SRINIVAS

After the drought, a refreshing respite

Sharp turn of weather brings relief to parts of Andhra Pradesh, which has been reeling under a severe rainfall deficit, attributed to the El Niño phenomenon

Two days of rain have redrawn a landscape that had borne the effects of a prolonged dry spell, compounded by El Niño-related weather patterns in Andhra Pradesh.

In June, the tank beds in the villages of Alluru and Gaadhepalem near Ongole lay baked and cracked under the summer heat, with concrete wells standing exposed amid the parched earth. Villagers walked long distances with pots and plastic containers to collect drinking water, while cattle wandered across empty lake beds. Now, the same landscape is almost unrecognisable. Fresh rainwater has swallowed the cracked earth, filled the tanks, and turned dusty, barren stretches into shimmering sheets of water. The striking change, captured just days apart, offers a vivid picture of how quickly the landscape can respond when the rains finally arrive.

Heavy rains and increased inflows have replenished water sources across the State.

In Vijayawada, rising inflows into the Krishna River basin prompted the Water Resources Department to lift the gates of the Prakasam

Barrage and regulate the discharge of floodwaters. Officials continued to monitor the inflows and regulate releases as water levels rose.

In Visakhapatnam, the Mudasarlova Reservoir, which had recorded depleted storage earlier, received sufficient inflows following the recent rains. At Gambheeram Gedda Reservoir, too, the contrast is striking. Just two days ago, only a few patches of water were visible in the reservoir. It is now brimming with water.

The change is particularly significant in the tail-end areas of Prakasam district, where several village tanks had dried up during the summer.

To address the shortage during the peak dry period, irrigation authorities in August released water from the Ramateertham Reservoir through the Nagarjuna Sagar Right Canal network to replenish summer storage tanks in the tail-end villages. The water was released specifically to meet drinking water requirements rather than for irrigation, officials said. The recent rains have now filled several of these tanks, covering the exposed beds and improving local water availability.

(Text by G.V.R Subba Rao)



Sudden surge: Gambheeram Gedda Reservoir, which had seen a sharp decline in water levels during the prolonged dry spell, is seen filled to the brim after the recent rains in Visakhapatnam. V. RAJU

